

Physical Education

Year 3

Student Manual



Physical Education • Year 3

Student Manual. First edition, 2026.

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Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in an orange **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body to succeed. Teachers adapt distances, heights and timings freely: the objective is control, not size.

The three big days. The dates on the next page but one are the Prime School plan for the academic year 2026/27. Confirm them against the school calendar before the year starts, because a term end can move.

British English throughout. Printed in Portugal on paper from responsibly managed forests.

About this book

This is the Year 3 Physical Education student book in the Prime Books collection. It is written for children of about seven and eight, and for the teachers and families who work with them.

Year 1 taught the fundamental movements themselves: run, jump, hop, skip, land, stop, throw, balance. Year 2 took those movements onto a marked court and into a team bib. Year 3 does not teach them again. It asks the child to **refine, combine, decide and look after** what they can already do.

Across the year the book develops:

- coordination, balance, agility, speed and age-appropriate strength
- stamina, reaction and spatial awareness
- object control: throw, catch, roll, kick, dribble, pass, strike
- movement combinations: run and jump and land, catch and pass, dribble and turn
- simple tactics: find space, support a teammate, choose when to pass
- teamwork, communication, confidence, sportsmanship and safe participation
- healthy active habits: warm-up, water, a sensible intensity, knowing today's limit

The six friends from Years 1 and 2 are still here: Pip, Bramble, Sorrel, Tuft, Willow and Rowan. The ground has changed. It is a measured meadow track, and the jobs on it are mover, timer and watcher.

Modified games appear inside the units: athletics, football, basketball, handball, striking and fielding, gymnastics, dance, relays. This remains a Physical Education book, not a specialist sports manual.



The six, between grounds. A quiet moment at the fence, kit at their feet, the hill in the distance. The year is long enough. Nobody needs to rush it.

Book description

Physical Education Year 3 is the next book in the Prime Books Physical Education line for Prime School. It follows the same six friends onto a new ground: a cinder track at the edge of a meadow, where a movement is practised until it is smooth, described until a teammate can use the words, and played until everybody in the game has a job.

Children learn to combine skills, use simple tactics, take a short turn at leading, share kit fairly, and notice what their own body is doing while it moves. Every comparison is against their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one child against another.

The book is for Year 3, ages seven to eight, and belongs on the same shelf as the Year 1 and Year 2 Physical Education titles. Same collection. Same cast. Harder work.

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The year at a glance

Three terms. Three big days. Every one of them uses something you learn in this book.

TERM 1 ENDS

Athletics Day

December 2026



- Sprint
- Relays
- Standing long jump
- Target throw
- Obstacle race

TERM 2 ENDS

Football Day

March 2027



- Dribbling in and out of the cones race
- Passing accuracy game
- Penalty shootout
- Full game

TERM 3 ENDS

Multi-sports Day

June 2027



- Bowling
- Sack racing
- Bean bag throw
- Water pong, a ball thrown into a row of water cups

How the year feeds the three days

Every activity above is a movement done **on purpose**. Unit 1 starts the work. The later grounds keep feeding the same three days.

FROM UNIT 1	ON ATHLETICS DAY	ON FOOTBALL DAY	ON MULTI-SPORTS DAY
1.1 practising until a movement is smooth	the standing long jump, where a smooth landing wins it	passing accuracy, which is ten quiet repetitions	the bean bag throw
1.2 joining movements with no stop	the obstacle race, which is all joins	dribbling in and out of the cones	sack racing, hop after hop

FROM UNIT 1	ON ATHLETICS DAY	ON FOOTBALL DAY	ON MULTI-SPORTS DAY
1.3 choosing your speed and level on purpose	the sprint, and pacing a relay leg	knowing when to slow down with the ball	bowling, where hard is usually wrong
1.4 keeping control when the ground changes	running on grass instead of clay	a full game, where nothing stays still	water pong and the bowling lane
Units 2 to 6	describing a sprint, warming up, knowing today's limit	tactics, roles, fair play, a useful call	sharing kit, asking for help, drinking water

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Look down the Athletics Day column. The **sprint** is the only activity there where being fastest is the whole answer. In the other four, a pupil who moves smoothly and knows exactly what their body is doing will beat a pupil who is simply quick.

That is not a comforting thing to say. It is the reason this book spends its first ground on control rather than on speed.

Welcome to the meadow track

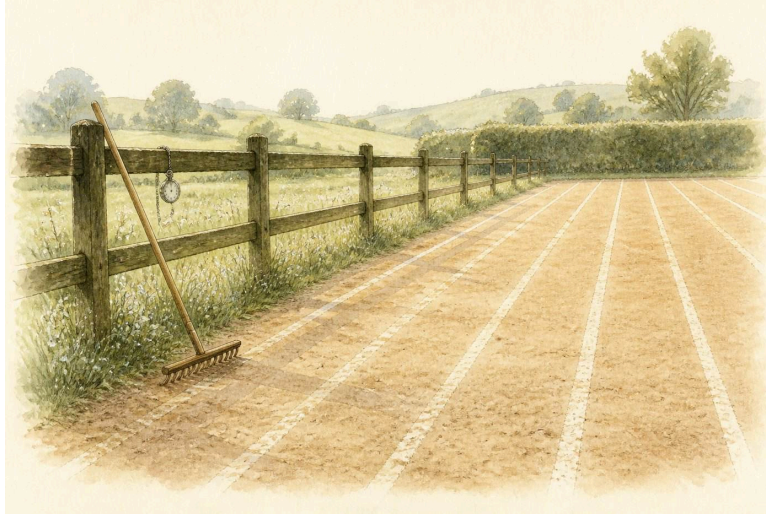
You already know how to run.

You learned that in Year 1, out in the meadow, along with jumping, hopping, skipping, landing softly and stopping where you meant to. Last year you took all of it onto a marked court and played in a team.

So this year is not about learning new movements. It is about something harder and much more interesting: **doing a movement you already know, better than you did it last week, and being able to say what changed.**

That is what the white lines are for. A measured ground lets you find out.

Here is the difference. In Year 1, "I can jump" was the whole answer. This year the answer sounds more like this: *I can land my jump without wobbling, and I can go straight into a roll afterwards, and if you ask me to do it slowly I can do that too.* Same jump. Far more control.



The track before anybody arrives. Six lanes brushed flat, a rake against the fence and one stopwatch left hanging on the rail. Look at the white lines: everything in this book happens between them.

THE FIELD · SIX GROUNDS, ONE FOR EACH UNIT

- 1 **The Cinder Track.** Practising a movement until it is smooth, joining movements together, and keeping control when the ground changes.
- 2 **The Watching Post.** Willow's place. Words for what a body actually did, and how to judge whether it worked.
- 3 **The Wide Meadow.** Finding movements nobody showed you, and moving to say something.
- 4 **The Team Field.** Your job, everybody else's job, and taking a turn at leading.
- 5 **The Kit Shed.** Sharing a space and a set of equipment safely, and what fair play really means.
- 6 **The Long Hill.** What happens inside you while you move, and what a moving body needs.

Six grounds. One year. The three jobs rotate on every one of them.

Three jobs, and you will do all of them

Almost every task in this book needs three people, because you cannot watch yourself move.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement, properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or change it halfway through
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, round the number kindly, or start the watch early
Watcher	Look at one thing only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all



Three jobs at once. Sorrel is moving, Bramble is timing and reading the watch, and Willow is writing down what she saw. Nobody is standing about, which is the point of working in threes.

Swap jobs every time. The watcher's job is the one most people are worst at, and it is the one that makes you better at the other two.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

The **watcher** is the job nobody wants and everybody needs. Ask any of the six which job they find hardest and five of them will say watching, because a watcher has to keep their mouth shut, look at one thing, and then describe it without saying whether they liked it.

Willow is the exception. She would rather watch than move, which is why her notes turn up all through this book as the model for yours.

Meet the six

The same six as last year, a year older.

Pip

Red squirrel, sage vest. Quick, and always first to try. This year he is finding out that his fastest attempt and his best attempt are not the same attempt.

Bramble

Badger, slate tracksuit. Strong and steady, and he never rushes. He holds the stopwatch, and he reads out the number that is actually on it.

Sorrel

Hare. The fastest of all of them. A hare has one brilliant speed, and this year she is learning that slow, low and smooth are also things you can be good at.

Tuft

Hedgehog. The smallest and the most careful. He reads the space before he moves into it, which is why he is almost never in anybody's way.



Willow

Barn owl. She watches, from up on the fence post where she can see the whole shape of a movement. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you saw instead of saying whether you liked it.

When you see her notes in a flint-grey panel, that is Willow telling you exactly what one body did. Copy the way she says it, not just what she says.

Rowan

Otter. Happiest in a group, and very good at giving everybody a job. If a task has four parts and six people, ask Rowan.

None of the six is better than the others. Each one is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap.

How to use this book

Every ground is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Come out to the track	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On this ground you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from Year 1 or Year 2 that you are about to need again.
Learn	The marked ground and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch me try	One attempt, taken slowly, with the reason for each part.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What a watcher actually wrote down. A model for your own.
Stay safe	Orange. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
The equipment you need	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Track challenge	Harder. Expect to need three attempts.
The meadow games	The project at the end of the ground.
How did it go?	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.
Words we used	Every new word, with its meaning.

The marked grounds

Wherever you see a warm clay panel with white chalk lines on it, you are looking at **the space seen from above**, the way Willow sees it. The marks always mean the same thing.

MARK	MEANS
a solid white line	a line you may not cross
a dashed white line	the route a body travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a small cross	a cone, a marker or a spot
the ticks down the left edge	paces, counted

Writing in this book

You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and that is the whole point.

Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each ground tells you what to fetch.

Your track kit

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- eight cones, or eight of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- two skipping ropes
- a hoop
- chalk, or a roll of low-tack tape, for marking a line on the floor
- a pencil, because half of this book gets written in
- five other people, which is the most important item on the list



Your kit, laid out. Not one thing here needs a screen. Count them against the list: shoes, a watch, four cones, two ropes, a hoop, a stub of chalk and a pencil. The chalk does most of the work in Unit 1.

Ground rules

- 1 Walk into the space. Everybody walks in, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look before you move. Tuft is right about this and he is right every lesson.
- 3 One mover at a time in a marked lane, unless the task says otherwise.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 Put the equipment back where it came from, at the end, without being asked.
- 7 Stop the moment you hear "stop". Not after this one. Now.

STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check three things and say them out loud:

The floor. Dry, clear, nothing to trip on, nothing to slide on. **The edges.**

Nothing hard within two paces of any line you might run past. **The apparatus.** Every bench, mat and hoop set out and tested by an adult, not by you.

If any of the three is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

How every task runs

Almost every task in this book has the same six steps. Learn them once and you will never have to be told the order again.

- 1 **Fetch.** Read *The equipment you need* at the top of the topic and collect it before anybody moves. One person fetches for the three of you.
- 2 **Mark the ground.** Chalk or tape the lines the task asks for. Walk the space once, empty, and move anything you would rather not run into.
- 3 **Agree the one thing.** Say out loud what the mover is trying to change, and what the watcher is going to look at. If you cannot say it in one short sentence, it is not one thing yet.
- 4 **Go.** The mover moves, the timer counts or times, the watcher looks. Nobody talks during a go except the timer, and the timer only says the number.
- 5 **Swap.** Every three goes, change jobs. By the end of the task all three of you will have moved, timed and watched.
- 6 **Put back.** Equipment goes back where it came from, chalk gets wiped or the tape lifted, and the space is left as you found it.

The step people skip is 3, and skipping it costs the whole task, because a watcher who does not know what to look at will fall back on saying "that was good".

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Rule 4 is the one everybody breaks, and it is worth knowing why it matters. A timer who takes a tenth of a second off to be nice has not been kind: they have thrown away the only evidence the mover had that their practice worked. Numbers are how you find out. A kind number is a useless number.

If something is hard

Some of these tasks will be hard for you and easy for the person next to you, and some will be the other way round. That is not a problem to be hidden. It is information, and it is the only kind this book actually cares about.

So when a task does not fit you, **change the task**. Ask for any of these:

- a shorter lane, or fewer paces to count
- a lower bench, a wider line, or the hoop on the floor instead of held up
- more goes, or a rest between goes
- to be the timer or the watcher first, and the mover afterwards
- the movement done sitting, kneeling or supported, if travelling is difficult

Every one of those still teaches the same thing, because the thing being taught is **control**, and control has nothing to do with how big or how fast you are. A pupil who holds a slow, low crossing all the way across has met the objective. A pupil who is quickest and cannot slow down has not.

Asking for a change is not giving up and it is not cheating. It is exactly what Rowan does when a task has four parts and six people: he changes the shape of the task so that everybody has a job. Do the same for yourself.

Looking after the kit

The equipment in this book is shared with every other class in the school, so two habits matter more than they sound.

Count it back in. Eight cones went out, eight cones come back. It takes ten seconds and it is the difference between the next class having a lesson and not.

Say when something breaks. A split hoop, a frayed rope, a bench with a wobble in it: tell an adult the moment you notice, not at the end. Nobody is ever in trouble for reporting a broken thing, and somebody could be hurt by a quiet one.

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 1 • CINDER TRACK

1

Moving well

You already know how to run, jump and land. This ground is about doing it better than you did it last week, and being able to say what changed.

At the Cinder Track you practise one movement until it is smooth, join movements into a sequence, change the speed and the level on purpose, and keep all of that control when somebody puts a bench in your way.



Picture 1.0 The Cinder Track on an ordinary afternoon. Pip is the only one moving. Bramble has the watch, Willow is up on the post where she can see the whole run, and Sorrel, Rowan and Tuft are waiting their turn. Five of the six are working, and only one of them is running.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ practise one movement on purpose, and say what got smoother
- ✓ join three movements into a sequence with no stop in the middle
- ✓ perform the same movement fast, slow, high and low, deliberately
- ✓ keep your control when the apparatus and the space change

○ Come out to the track

Think of something your body does well. Catching. Skipping. Running round a bend.

Now answer a harder question. **How did it get good?**

Almost nobody can remember. It got good quietly, from doing it over and over without paying much attention. This unit does the same thing loudly, on purpose, so that you can see it happening and make it happen faster.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1**Making a movement smoother****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Two cones, chalk or tape for one line, a stopwatch or a wall clock, and a pencil. Work in threes.

✦ WARM UP

Walk briskly anywhere in the space for one minute, changing direction whenever you meet somebody, without touching anybody. Then roll your shoulders back five times and rise onto your toes five times.

Now stand still. Your body is warm, your ankles are awake, and you are ready. Cold practice is wasted practice.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip does a standing jump. It is a big jump, and he lands with a thump, and his hands go out sideways to stop himself falling over.

He does it nine more times. Every one of them is a big jump with a thump and the hands going out.

Bramble says, "That was ten jumps." Willow says, "That was the same jump ten times."

They are both right, and Willow's version is the useful one.

► Learn

Doing a movement ten times is not the same as practising it.

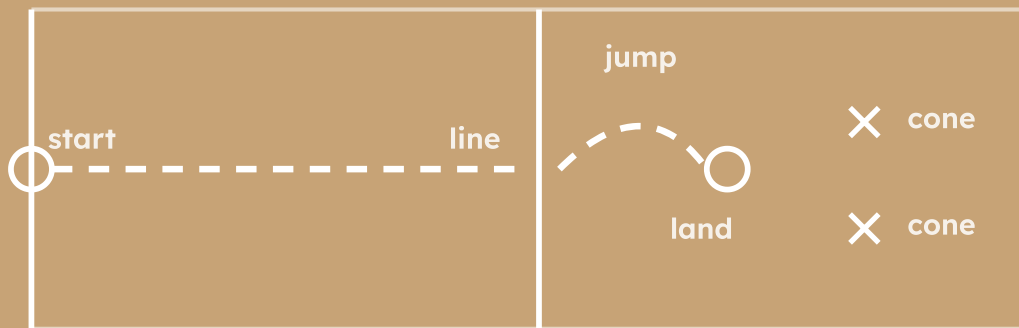
Practice means repeating a movement *with something you are trying to change*. Without that, you are only keeping fit, which is fine, but nothing gets smoother.

Three things make a practice work.

IT MUST HAVE	WHICH MEANS
One thing to change	Not "jump better". "Land with my knees bent and my hands still."
A way to tell	A watcher looking at that one thing, or a number from the timer.
Enough goes	Three attempts tell you nothing. Ten start to tell you something.

A movement that has been practised properly looks **smooth**: it has no wasted wobble, no extra step, and no arm shooting out to save it. Smooth is not the same as fast. Smooth usually turns out to be faster anyway, which surprises people.

GROUND 1.1 · THE PRACTICE LANE



Solid white lines are the two lines you may not cross: the start and the take-off. The dashed line is Pip's route, a run-up and then one jump. The two crosses are cones, set beyond the landing ring so nobody runs into them.



One thing, and only one thing. This is what Pip is practising: knees bent, and both paws hanging quietly at his sides. Willow has already looked, and now she is writing it down. That is what makes it practice instead of just ten more jumps.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Pip tries again, this time properly. He picks **one** thing to change: *land with bent knees and still hands*. Willow watches only the hands. Bramble counts the wobbles.

GO	HANDS	WOBBLES	WHAT PIP CHANGED NEXT
1	shot out sideways	2	nothing yet, that was the first one
2	shot out sideways	2	bend the knees more on landing
3	one hand out	1	keep bending the knees
4	one hand out	1	look ahead, not down at the floor
5	still	0	nothing. Do that again.
6	still	0	nothing. Do that again.

Look at goes 5 and 6. When something works you do **not** change it. You repeat it until it is the thing your body does without being asked.

And look at go 4. Pip changed **one** thing at a time. If he had bent his knees, looked ahead and swung his arms differently all at once, and go 4 had come out smooth, he would not know which of the three had done it.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

*Go 1: hands out sideways, knees straight, landed heavy on the heels.
Go 5: hands stayed by his sides, knees bent, landed on the front of the feet and stopped dead.*

Notice what Willow did not write. She did not write "much better". She wrote what the hands did, what the knees did and what the feet did. That is a watcher's job, and it is the whole reason Pip knew what to keep.



The same jump, ten times, on purpose. This is Pip's sixth go. Look only at his hands: they are hanging quietly at his sides, which is the one thing he set out to change. Bramble is down at the line with the watch, and the other three are watching that same detail.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Rosa Mota ran the marathon for Portugal. She won the Olympic gold medal in Seoul in 1988, in 2 hours 25 minutes and 40 seconds, and she won it by 13 seconds. She also won the world title in Rome in 1987 and the European title three times, in 1982, 1986 and 1990.

Eight years lie between her first European title and her last. She did not win those by discovering a new way to run. She won them by going back to the same movement, over and over, and refining it.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose one movement you can already do: a standing jump, a hop on one foot, a two-handed catch, or a stop from a fast walk. Write it down, then write the **one thing** you will change.

I will practise

The one thing I will change is

- 2 Do it ten times. Your watcher looks only at your one thing. Your timer counts the wobbles. Fill this in as you go.

GO	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	WOBBLES
1		
4		
7		
10		

- 3 Tick the one that is true.
- ☐ Go 10 was smoother than go 1.
- ☐ Go 10 was about the same as go 1.
- ☐ Go 10 was worse, because I got tired.
- 4 If you ticked the third box, that is a real answer and a useful one. Write what you would do differently next lesson.

→ **GO A LITTLE FURTHER**

Swap jobs with your watcher and do the whole thing again on **their** movement.

Then answer this out loud: was it easier to be the mover or the watcher?

Most people find watching harder, because saying exactly what a body did is a skill of its own. That is Unit 2, and it starts here.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

Joining movements together

 THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, four cones, one mat if your space has them. Work in threes.

 DO YOU REMEMBER?

What are the three things that make a practice work, from 1.1?

One thing to change. _____

 WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel can run, and she can jump, and she can turn. Rowan asks her to do all three, one after the other, across the hall.

She runs. She stops. She jumps. She stops. She turns.

"That was all three," says Sorrel.

"That was three movements and two stops," says Willow.

► Learn

A **sequence** is two or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle. The end of one movement becomes the start of the next.

The joins are the hard part, and they are the only part worth practising, because you can already do the movements.

IN A SEQUENCE, EACH MOVEMENT NEEDS	WHY
a finish that faces the right way	You cannot start a movement while facing the wrong direction
a finish that keeps some speed	A movement that stops dead has thrown away everything the last one gave it
a balance you can leave from	You can only move on from a position you are actually steady in

So the question at every join is the same: **can I begin the next movement from exactly where this one left me?** If the answer is no, the join is where you practise, not the movements.

GROUND 1.2 · THREE MOVEMENTS, TWO JOINS

The diagram illustrates a sequence of three movements: 'run', 'jump', and 'turn', connected by two 'joins'. The sequence starts with a 'start' circle, followed by a dashed line for 'run' leading to 'join 1'. From 'join 1', a dashed arc for 'jump' leads to 'join 2'. From 'join 2', a dashed line for 'turn' leads to a 'finish' circle. Two short upright chalk marks indicate the joins.

The two short upright chalk marks are the joins. Everything before and after them is a movement Sorrel can already do. The join is the only new work on this page.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

The triple jump is a sequence with two joins in it, and the rules name all three parts. An athlete makes a **hop**, landing on the same foot they took off from, then a **step** onto the other foot, then a **jump** into the sand. The three happen in one continuous run, without stopping.

Nelson Évora won the Olympic gold medal in the triple jump for Portugal in Beijing in 2008.

Three movements, two joins. Exactly what is on the ground drawing above, and exactly what you are about to practise across the hall.



Hop, step, jump. Sorrel doing the same thing a triple jumper does. Follow her feet left to right: she takes off from one foot and lands on it, then pushes on from the other foot, then leaps. Look at the footprints between the three pictures. There is no gap where she stopped.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Sorrel tries the run, jump, turn sequence again, and this time she practises only join 1.

Attempt 1. She runs, then stops, then jumps. *Join 1 failed: she arrived at the line with both feet together and no speed left.*

Attempt 2. She runs and takes off from the last running stride instead of stopping first. *Join 1 worked.* Now join 2 fails, because she lands the jump facing straight ahead and the turn needs her shoulder round.

Attempt 3. Same run, same take-off, and she lands the jump with her knees bent and her shoulders already beginning to turn. *Both joins worked.* One sequence, no stops.

Read attempt 2 again, because it is the most useful one. Fixing join 1 **revealed** a problem at join 2 that had been hiding behind the stop. That is normal. It is not going backwards.



The join, not the jump. Sorrel is off the ground and still travelling forward, because she took off from her last running stride instead of stopping first. Rowan is pointing at the join. Nothing in this picture has stopped.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Build a sequence of three movements from this list. Write your three in order, then mark each of the two joins with an arrow.

run • jump • hop • skip • turn • roll • balance • stop

OUR SEQUENCE	
1	
2	
3	

Two joins. Mark them with an arrow.

- 2 Run it three times. After each go, the watcher says which join was weaker. Write the weaker join, not the whole sequence.

GO	THE WEAKER JOIN WAS
1	
2	
3	

- 3 Draw your route on the ground below. Use the marks you learned in *How to use this book*: a dashed line for the route, a ring for the start and the finish, and a short upright mark at each join.

OUR ROUTE, SEEN FROM ABOVE

- 4 Tick every one that is true of your third go.
- ☐ There was no stop in the middle.
 - ☐ I finished facing the way I meant to.
 - ☐ I could have added a fourth movement straight afterwards.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence so that a watcher who has never seen it can write down all three movements **and** both joins, without asking you a single question.

If they miss one, do not explain it. Change the sequence so it explains itself, and try again. A sequence that needs talking through is a sequence that is not finished.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Fast, slow, high, low

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, six cones, a drum or a tambourine if your teacher has one. Work in threes.

✦ WARM UP

Travel from one side of the space to the other four times, on your teacher's signal: once as fast as you safely can, once as slowly as you possibly can, once as tall as you can, and once as low as you can.

The slow one is the hardest. Almost everybody speeds up in the middle.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel is asked to cross the hall slowly.

She sets off slowly, gets bored halfway, and arrives at the far side at her normal speed without noticing she has changed.

"You went slowly," says Tuft, "for about four paces."

► Learn

The same movement can be done in many different ways. The way you do it is called its **dynamics**.

There are four dials, and you can turn each one without changing the movement itself.

DIAL	TURN IT DOWN	TURN IT UP
Speed	slowly, in your own time	quickly, at full pace
Level	low, close to the floor	high, tall, up on the toes
Size	small, tight, contained	large, stretched, reaching
Force	light, quiet, gentle	strong, firm, powerful

Turning a dial **on purpose and keeping it there** is the skill. Sorrel did not fail because she cannot go slowly. She failed because she did not keep the dial where she put it.



One hedgehog, four settings. Tuft travelling four different ways. Tall and stretched, then low and flat, then large reaching strides, then small tight steps. It is the same hedgehog and the same journey every time. Only the dial has moved.

There is a second half to this, and it is about the space. Where you travel matters as much as how.

IN THE SPACE YOU CAN CHANGE	FOR EXAMPLE
direction	forwards, backwards, sideways, diagonally
pathway	a straight line, a curve, a zigzag
where you are	near a wall, out in the middle, close to a partner

GROUND 1.3 · ONE ROUTE, FOUR DYNAMICS

FAST



dashes close together

SLOW



dashes far apart

HIGH



same route, up tall

LOW, STRONG



same route, thick line

Four grounds, one route. Look only at the chalk: close dashes mean fast, spread dashes mean slow, and a thick line means strong. The zigzag never changes. Everything else does.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Tuft crosses the hall four times on the same zigzag, changing one dial each time, and Bramble times him.

GO	DIAL SET TO	TIME	DID HE KEEP IT THERE?
1	fast	6 s	yes
2	slow	14 s	no, quick over the last two corners
3	slow, second try	21 s	yes
4	low	11 s	yes, knees bent the whole way

Compare go 2 with go 3. Seven whole seconds separate them, on the same route, with the same instruction. Go 2 was not slow. It only started slow.

This is why the timer matters in this topic. "Slowly" is an opinion. Twenty-one seconds is a fact.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

A European hare can run at about 70 kilometres an hour. Sorrel, who is a hare, is faster than anybody else in the meadow and always has been.

That is one dial, turned all the way up, and it is the only setting a hare really needs in the wild, because a hare escapes by outrunning things in the open.

You are not a hare. In a hall, in a game and in a gymnastics sequence, the useful skill is being able to put the dial anywhere you like and leave it there.



The same crossing, four ways. Sorrel is going low and slow, the setting she finds hardest. Now look at the chalk under her: her path curves wide around the cone, because a body held that low cannot turn sharply. She did not choose that. The dial chose it for her.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Mark a zigzag route with four cones. Cross it four times, changing one dial each time. Your timer writes the time; your watcher writes whether you kept the dial where you put it.

GO	DIAL SET TO	TIME	KEPT IT THERE?
1	fast	_____	_____
2	slow	_____	_____
3	high	_____	_____
4	low	_____	_____

2 Which two of your four times are furthest apart?

Go _____ and go _____

3 Now do the hardest one again and try to make it more extreme. Slower than slowly. Lower than low.

New time _____

4 Match each instruction to the dial it changes. Write the dial in the box.

INSTRUCTION	DIAL
"Cross the hall like a heavy giant."	
"Make yourself as small as a mouse and travel."	
"Go so slowly I cannot see you moving."	
"Travel on your toes with your arms stretched up."	

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1, fast: shoulders forward, arms driving, cut the corners tight.

Go 4, low: knees bent all the way across, back flat, took the corners wide because a low body cannot turn sharply.

Willow has spotted something the mover did not: going low **forced** a wider pathway. Change one dial and something else changes with it. Watchers find that out before movers do.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Do your zigzag with two dials changed at once: slow **and** low, or fast **and** small.

Which pairs work together, and which pair fights? Most classes find fast and small comfortable, and slow and strong surprisingly difficult to hold for a whole crossing.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

New apparatus, same control

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One bench, two hoops, one mat, four cones. **A teacher sets out and tests every piece before the lesson begins.**

STAY SAFE

Apparatus changes what a mistake costs, so three rules are not negotiable.

- 1 An adult sets out and tests every bench, mat and hoop. You never move apparatus into place yourself, and you never move it while somebody is using it.
- 2 One mover on a piece of apparatus at a time. Wait behind the cone, not beside the bench.
- 3 Any wobble at all in a bench or a mat: stop, step off, tell an adult. Do not test it again to see whether it does it twice.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.3, name the four dials you can change without changing the movement.

WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft has a beautiful smooth sequence on the floor: run, jump, land, turn. He has practised it for two lessons and it has no stops in it at all.

Rowan puts a bench across the middle of it.

Tuft runs, arrives at the bench, stops completely, climbs onto it carefully, gets off the other side, and then does his jump and his turn.

Every movement is still there. The sequence has gone.

► Learn

A movement you can only do on an empty floor is only half learned.

Apparatus is the equipment you move on, over and through: benches, mats, hoops, ropes, cones. When the apparatus changes, three things change with it.

WHAT CHANGES	WHAT IT DOES TO YOUR MOVEMENT
The surface	A bench is narrow, so your feet must land in a line, not side by side
The height	Coming down from a bench is faster than coming down from a jump, so you need more bend in the knees
The shape of the space	A hoop decides where your feet go. You cannot choose your own spot any more

Tuft did not lose his control. He lost his **adaptation**: the small changes that let the same movement work on a new surface. And adaptation is practised exactly the way 1.1 said, one thing at a time.

The rule for the whole topic is short. **Keep the movement. Change the detail.**

GROUND 1.4 · THE SAME SEQUENCE, WITH APPARATUS IN IT

start bench hoop hoop mat

One route, four pieces of apparatus. The bench is narrow so the feet land in a line. The two hoops decide where each foot goes. The shaded square is the mat, which is where the sequence finishes. The crosses are cones marking where the next mover waits.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

A gymnastics balance beam used in competition is **10 centimetres wide**. It is 5 metres long and it stands 1.25 metres above the floor.

Ten centimetres is about the length of your thumb and your first finger together. Put your hands out and look at it, because that is the surface a gymnast runs, turns and somersaults on.

They did not learn any of that on a beam. They learned it on a line chalked on the floor, then on a bench, then on a low beam, then on a high one. Same movement. Changed detail, four times over.



A chalk line, then a bench, then a beam. Tuft doing exactly what a gymnast does, in the order a gymnast does it. His arms are out level and his eyes are forward in all three. The only thing that changed is what he is standing on.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Tuft goes back to his run, jump, land, turn sequence with the bench in it, and changes one detail at a time.

Attempt 1. He runs at the bench and stops. *The problem is the arrival, not the bench.*

Attempt 2. He shortens his run-up by two paces so he arrives at the bench on the correct foot. He steps up, then down, then stops. *Better. One stop left, on the way down.*

Attempt 3. He comes off the bench into the jump instead of landing first, and bends his knees more because the bench has given him extra height. *No stops.*

Same four movements he had two lessons ago. Two small details changed: a shorter run-up and a deeper knee bend.



Coming off the bench into the jump. Tuft has not landed on the floor first. Look at his knees: they are bending more than they did on the flat, because the bench gave him extra height to absorb.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Take the sequence you built in 1.2. Add **one** piece of apparatus to it. Write which piece, and where.

The apparatus I added is _____

I put it

2 Run it three times and write what you changed each time. Change one detail per go, as Tuft did.

GO	THE ONE DETAIL I CHANGED	ANY STOPS?
1	_____	_____
2	_____	_____
3	_____	_____

3 Which of the three things in the table changed most for you? Tick one.

- ☐ the surface, because my feet had to land differently
- ☐ the height, because I came down faster
- ☐ the shape of the space, because the apparatus chose where I went

4 Draw the ground you used, with the apparatus on it. Use a rectangle for a bench, a circle for a hoop, a shaded square for a mat, and a dashed line for your route.

OUR GROUND, WITH THE APPARATUS ON IT

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Swap grounds with another three. Perform **their** apparatus sequence, from their drawing only, without them telling you anything.

Then tell them the one detail you had to change to make it work on your body. It will not be the same detail they changed, and that is the interesting bit: two bodies adapt the same route differently.

The meadow games

Six friends, three jobs, one sequence each.

This is everything from the Cinder Track at once. You will build a sequence, practise one thing in it until it is smooth, set it on apparatus, perform it at two different dynamics, and have a watcher describe it back to you. Your work is finished when the watcher's description matches what you meant to do.

A MEADOW GAMES SEQUENCE IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
it has three movements and no stop between them	it is three movements with a rest in the middle
it uses at least one piece of apparatus	it stays on the flat floor where it is easy
it can be performed fast and slow on purpose	it only has one speed
a watcher can describe it without asking you	you have to explain it first
it finishes in a balance you could hold to a count of three	it finishes by running out of control



The meadow games. All six of them, three performing and three watching, and the watchers have the pencils. Nobody is being marked. Everybody is being described.

THE MEADOW GAMES · THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Build it.** Three movements, two joins, at least one piece of apparatus. Draw the ground before you move.
- 2 **Smooth it.** Choose one thing to change and practise it ten times, as in 1.1. Your timer counts the wobbles.
- 3 **Set the dials.** Perform the whole sequence fast, then slow. Both on purpose. Both held all the way through.
- 4 **Be described.** A watcher writes down every movement, both joins and the dynamics, without speaking to you.
- 5 **Compare.** Read what the watcher wrote beside what you meant. Where they differ, the sequence is not clear yet, not the watcher.

What good looks like: their description and your plan say the same thing.

Step 5 is the one that matters, and it is the one everybody wants to argue about. If the watcher wrote "then she sort of stopped and did a turn", you did stop. The watcher is not being unfair. They are being a mirror, which is the most useful thing a person can be.

Our sequence, written down before we move

OUR MEADOW GAMES SEQUENCE

1

2

3

Apparatus we used, and where we put it:

OUR GROUND, DRAWN BEFORE WE MOVED

WHAT THE WATCHER WROTE AFTERWARDS

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Three movements: a run, a jump off the bench, and a turn to a still balance.

Join 1 was clean. Join 2 had a small step in it that I do not think was planned.

Fast go: held all the way. Slow go: slowed for the run, then went back to normal speed after the bench.

Finished in a balance and held it past three.

That is what a full description looks like. It names the movements, judges both joins separately, checks both dynamics, and says what the finish did. Not one word of it says whether Willow enjoyed it.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.

AT THE CINDER TRACK	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I practised one movement with one thing to change	☐ ☐ ☐
My tenth go was smoother than my first	☐ ☐ ☐
I joined three movements with no stop in the middle	☐ ☐ ☐
I changed a dial on purpose and kept it there all the way	☐ ☐ ☐
I kept my control when apparatus was added	☐ ☐ ☐
As a watcher, I said what I saw instead of saying "good"	☐ ☐ ☐
As a timer, I read out the number that was really on the watch	☐ ☐ ☐

The two rows about being a watcher and a timer are worth as much as the five about moving. A class where nobody watches properly is a class where nobody

improves, because there is no way to find out whether anything changed.

▣ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ practise one movement on purpose, with one thing to change
- ☐ say what got smoother, using words about my body and not about my feelings
- ☐ join three movements into a sequence with no stop at either join
- ☐ name the four dials: speed, level, size and force
- ☐ perform the same movement at two different dynamics, deliberately
- ☐ keep my control when a bench, a hoop or a mat is added
- ☐ describe somebody else's movement so they know exactly what they did
- ☐ read a stopwatch out honestly, even when the number is disappointing

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 2 · WATCHING POST

2

Understanding movement

Year 1 asked you to move. Year 2 asked you to move with a partner. This ground asks you to look, name what you saw, and decide what to do next.

At the Watching Post you learn the words for what a body did, the four things a watcher looks at, a fair way to judge a go, and the simple plan inside a game.



Picture 2.0 Willow on the post, notebook open. Below her, Pip is mid-run and Bramble is mid-count. The useful work in this picture is happening at the top of the post, not on the clay.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ describe a movement using the words this book already taught you
- ✓ name the action, the dynamic, the space and the relationship in what you saw
- ✓ use a short list of criteria to say what was successful and what to change
- ✓ follow a simple rule and use a simple tactic in a small game

○ Come out to the track

Think of the last game you played in the hall.

Can you say, in one sentence, what your body actually did?

Most people say "I ran about." That is not a description. It is a shrug. This unit turns the shrug into a sentence a teammate can use.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1**Words for what a body did****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

A pencil, one notebook or the boxes in this book, and a clear space. Work in threes: mover, watcher, timer.

✦ WARM UP

Travel anywhere in the space for one minute. Freeze on the teacher's clap. Hold whatever shape you are in. Look at the person nearest you. Do not speak yet.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip finishes a sequence. "How was that?" he asks.

"Good," says Rowan.

Pip does it again, exactly the same, because "good" told him nothing to change.

► Learn

A useful description names **what the body did**, not whether you liked it.

WEAK	USEFUL
good	you landed with both feet together
fast	you crossed in six seconds
messy	you stopped between the hop and the jump
try harder	keep your eyes on the cone, not on your feet

Year 3 words you already own: *smooth, wobble, sequence, join, dynamics, level, pathway, control*. Use them. Inventing a new word when an old one fits is showing off, not watching.



Willow writing, not cheering. She is looking at one thing: Pip's landing. The rest of the sequence is happening and she is ignoring it on purpose.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow watches Pip's standing jump and writes five words: *take-off still, knees bent, hands quiet, landing held, facing the line.*

She does not write *nice* or *better*. Pip can practise from those five words without asking her anything else.

🔄 DO YOU REMEMBER?

In Unit 1, what three things make a practice work?

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch your mover do one standing jump. Write **four** words or short phrases that name what the body did. No opinions.

FOUR THINGS THE BODY DID

- 2 Read your words back to the mover. Tick what they can use.
- ☐ they know which body part to change
 - ☐ they know where in the movement it happens
 - ☐ I did not write good, bad, nice or messy
- 3 Swap jobs. Do the same for a hop, then for a throw into a hoop.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Describe a classmate's movement so well that a third person, who had their back turned, can copy it without seeing it. If they cannot, the words are not finished.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Hands came up on the landing. That is the wobble. The take-off itself was still.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Action, dynamic, space, relationship

THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six cones, chalk, one soft ball. Work in fours.

✦ WARM UP

On four signals, travel: forwards, sideways, in a curve, then freeze close to a partner without touching.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft watches Sorrel dribble a football around three cones.

"She went that way," he says, waving a paw.

Bramble asks which way, how fast, how close to the cones, and whether anyone was with her. Tuft cannot answer any of the four.

► Learn

Every movement can be watched through four windows. Miss one and the picture has a hole in it.

WINDOW	THE QUESTION	YEAR 3 WORDS
Action	What did the body do?	run, jump, hop, throw, catch, roll, kick, strike, land, balance
Dynamic	How was it done?	fast or slow, high or low, strong or light, large or small
Space	Where did it travel?	direction, pathway, near a line, out in the middle
Relationship	Who or what was it with?	alone, beside a partner, towards a target, away from a defender

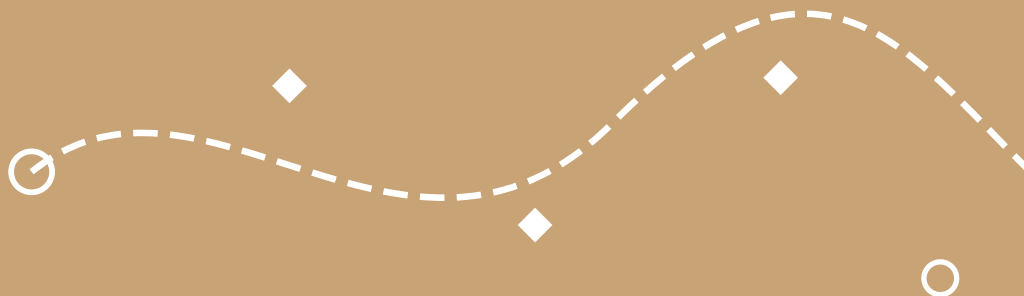
A complete watcher sentence uses all four.

Sorrel (action) dribbled the ball (dynamic) slowly (space) along a curved pathway between the cones (relationship) with nobody marking her.



Four windows, one dribble. Sorrel on the grass, ball at her feet, cones in a curve, Rowan standing off to the side so she has space. Look at all four things before you write.

GROUND 2.2 · FOUR WINDOWS ON ONE GO



Dashed curve = the pathway. Crosses = cones. The small ring off the line is the partner who is not in the way. The start ring is the only place the mover begins.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow writes Sorrel's dribble in four boxes, not one sentence, so nothing is forgotten.

WINDOW	WHAT SHE WROTE
Action	dribble, right foot, ball stays close
Dynamic	slow, then a little faster after the last cone
Space	curved pathway, never a straight line
Relationship	alone with the ball, cones as the only other thing

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch one go. Fill all four windows.

WINDOW	WHAT I SAW
Action	_____
Dynamic	_____
Space	_____
Relationship	_____

- 2 Which window was hardest to fill?

- 3 Play a one-minute 2 v 1 with a soft ball (two attackers, one defender). Watch one attacker. Write the relationship window only. Who were they near, and when?

RELATIONSHIP: WHO, AND WHEN

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Watch a go with your back half-turned, so you only see it from the corner of your eye. Fill the four windows. Then watch the same go properly. Which window did you guess? That is the window you do not yet look at first.

🚩 STAY SAFE

In any 2 v 1, the defender may intercept the ball. They may not reach for the attacker's body. If the ball is lost, freeze, reset, go again.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

What good looks like

📋 THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The criteria card in this topic, a pencil, the same three jobs. One bench or a line of cones.

✦ WARM UP

Balance on one foot for a count of eight. Swap feet. Then do it again with eyes on a fixed mark on the wall.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan judges every go by whether it looked "sporty".

Tuft's careful, still landing fails. Pip's wild, long jump passes.

The class gets worse at landing and better at looking busy.

► Learn

A **criterion** is one thing you have agreed to look at before anybody moves.

Good criteria are:

- short
- about the body or the space
- yes or no, or a number
- agreed **before** the first go

USEFUL CRITERION	USELESS CRITERION
both feet land together	be more sporty
no extra step after the landing	try your best
the ball hits the target	look like a footballer
the sequence has no stop	be creative

Three criteria are enough. Ten criteria mean nobody is watching anything.



The criteria card before the first go. Bramble holds it up. Nobody has moved yet. That is the point.

✧ DID YOU KNOW?

Judges in Olympic gymnastics agree the criteria before the first athlete steps onto the floor. They do not invent them halfway through because one jump looked exciting. The International Gymnastics Federation publishes the rules in advance so every gymnast trains towards the same list.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose **three** criteria for a run, jump, land. Write them before anyone moves.

#	OUR CRITERION	YES / NO
1		
2		

#	OUR CRITERION	YES / NO
---	---------------	----------

3

- 2 Each mover has three goes. The watcher ticks the criteria, not a score out of ten.
- 3 After three goes, name the one criterion that failed most often. That is the next practice, not a new sequence.

The one to practise next:

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Swap criteria cards with another three. Perform **their** sequence against **their** list. Then say which criterion you would add, and why. Adding is allowed. Changing theirs to make yourself look better is not.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Rules, and the plan inside a game

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One soft ball, four cones for a small pitch, bibs if you have them. Groups of six: 3 v 3.

✦ WARM UP

3 v 3, no ball. Attackers try to run through a four-cone gate. Defenders may only shadow, never touch. Thirty seconds, then swap.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The six play meadow ball, which is handball with a bounce allowed.

Pip always runs at the goal with the ball. He scores once and loses the ball five times.

Willow, who is not even playing, says from the post: "Two of you were free."

► Learn

A **rule** is what you may and may not do. A **tactic** is the simple plan you use inside those rules.

Year 3 tactics are small and practical. They are not adult formations.

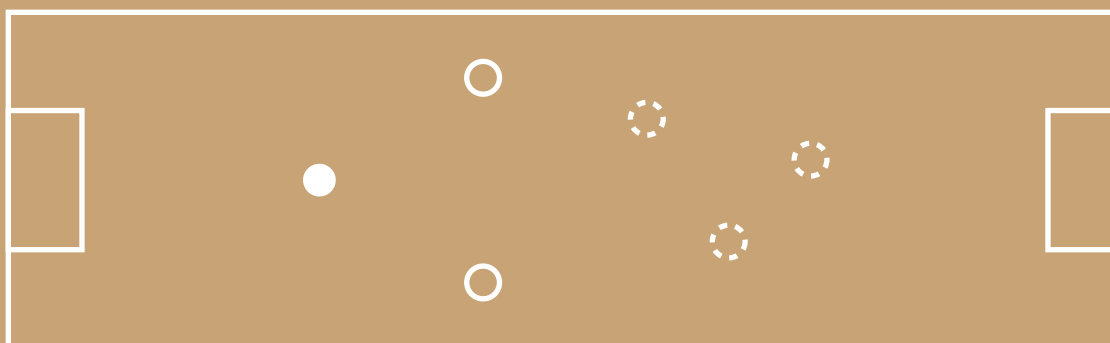
TACTIC	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Find space	stand where there is grass, not where there is a teammate
Move into space	leave the crowded place and arrive in the empty one
Support	be a place your teammate can pass to
Pass, then move	the ball leaves your hands, then you leave that spot
Defend the space	stand between the ball and the goal, not on the attacker

The rule and the tactic are different jobs. "You may bounce once" is a rule. "Bounce, then pass to the free player" is a tactic.



Two free, one crowded. Pip runs at the goal with the ball. Sorrel and Rowan stand in empty grass to his left and right, waiting. The picture is the tactic.

GROUND 2.4 · 3 V 3 MEADOW BALL



Filled circle = the player with the ball. Open circles = teammates in space. Dashed circles = defenders. The plan is: do not run at the dashed circles. Pass to an open one.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow's plan for Pip's team, written on one line:

If two defenders come to the ball, pass. If one defender comes, dribble into the space they left.

That is the whole tactic. It fits on a card. It does not need a whiteboard.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

Name the four watcher windows from 2.2.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Write two rules for your meadow-ball game, then one tactic.

Our rules:

Our tactic:

- 2 Play 3 v 3 for three minutes. After each goal or each restart, the watcher says whether the tactic was used.

RESTART	TACTIC USED?	WHAT HAPPENED INSTEAD
1		
2		
3		

- 3 Change one rule (for example: you must pass before you shoot). Play again. What did the new rule do to the tactic?

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Play the same 3 v 3 with a new tactic only: **nobody may dribble**. The ball must move by passing. After two minutes, say whether finding space got easier or harder, and why.

▮ STAY SAFE

Soft ball only. No slide. No reaching for arms. Freeze on the teacher's call before you argue a rule.

The watching games

Everything from the Watching Post at once. One sequence, one description, one set of criteria, one small game.

A WATCHING-GAMES PIECE IS FINISHED WHEN	IT IS NOT FINISHED WHEN
the description uses all four windows	it only says good or messy
three criteria were written before the first go	the criteria appeared afterwards
the tactic can be said in one sentence	nobody can remember what the plan was
a watcher who missed the go can still picture it	you have to act it out again



The watching games. Three movers, three watchers, one card of criteria on the grass between them. The card is the most important object in the picture.

Our watching-games card

BEFORE ANYBODY MOVES

Our three criteria:

1

2

3

Our one-sentence tactic:

How did Unit 2 go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet.

I can describe a movement without using good or messy.

I can fill all four windows: action, dynamic, space, relationship.

I can write three criteria before the first go.

I can follow a rule and use a simple tactic in a small game.

☐ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ I used Year 3 words, not shrugs, to say what a body did.
- ☐ I looked at space and relationship, not only at the person with the ball.
- ☐ I judged a go against a list we had already written.
- ☐ I found space, or I passed to someone who had.

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 3 • WIDE MEADOW

3

Moving creatively

The Cinder Track taught you to refine a movement.
The Watching Post taught you to name it. The Wide Meadow asks you to invent one.

Here you find a movement nobody showed you, let the apparatus suggest the next idea, answer a task with your body, and build a short dance or gymnastic phrase that has a mood.



Picture 3.0 The fence is behind them. The meadow is wide and unmarked. Rowan is mid-turn with a ribbon, Tuft is upside-down-ish on a hoop, and nobody is in a lane. That is the point of this ground.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ invent a movement or a short pattern that was not demonstrated first
- ✓ use apparatus as an idea, not only as an obstacle
- ✓ answer a given task with a movement, then choose a task of your own
- ✓ build a short sequence that expresses a theme, a mood or a weather

○ Come out to the track

Copying is how you learned to land. Copying is not how you make a dance.

This unit is the first time the book asks you to bring something that is not already on the page.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1**Finding a movement nobody showed you****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

An empty half of the hall, and permission to look a bit unusual. Work alone first, then in pairs.

✦ WARM UP

Travel for one minute using a body part that is not your feet as the thing that leads. A shoulder, an elbow, the top of the head. Freeze. Notice what that did to the rest of you.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The teacher says, "Show me a way of travelling I have not already taught you."

Half the class run. The other half skip. Both of those were taught in Year 1.

Tuft rolls sideways along the line of his spines, slowly, and arrives somewhere new.

► Learn

A **creative movement** is one you chose, not one you were shown.

It still has to be safe, and it still has to be controllable. Inventing a collapse is not creative. It is falling over.

Three honest ways to find a new movement:

START FROM	THEN CHANGE
a movement you know	one dial, or the body part that leads
a shape you can hold	a way of getting into it, or out of it
a word	<i>heavy, tiny, sticky, sudden</i>

The test is simple. If a watcher who knows Year 1 and Year 2 says "I have seen that one", keep changing it.



Tuft inventing a roll. He is not copying a taught forward roll. He is travelling along his own shape. Look at how slowly he is going: invention is easier at a speed you can still steer.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow gives Pip the word *sticky*.

He tries a run. It looks like a run. He tries walking with the soles of his feet peeling off the floor on every step, as if the clay were warm tar. That one is new. He keeps it.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Invent three ways of travelling across the meadow. None of them may be a run, a skip, a hop or a jump you have already been taught.

GO

WHAT I INVENTED

COULD I STOP IT SAFELY?

1

GO	WHAT I INVENTED	COULD I STOP IT SAFELY?
2	_____	_____
3	_____	_____

- 2 Keep the one you can still control. Teach it to a partner without speaking. Only show.
- 3 Put your two invented travels together with one still shape in the middle.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Your partner names a word you have not prepared (*crumbly, late, fizzy, fog*). You have ten seconds, then you move. The movement must match the word well enough that a third person can guess it.

🚩 STAY SAFE

Invention stops at the floor. No flips, no lifts of another body, no movement you cannot see the end of. If you are not sure you can land it, you have not invented it yet.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

What the apparatus suggests

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A hoop, a bench, a mat, a rope or a ribbon: one piece per pair, then swap.

✦ WARM UP

Walk the edge of a hoop without stepping in. Then step in and out on a slow count of eight.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

A hoop is put down.

Pip jumps in and out of it, which is what a hoop always gets used for.

Rowan lies the hoop on its side and rolls it, then travels through the moving circle before it falls.

Same hoop. Different idea.

► Learn

Apparatus is not only something to get over. It is a **suggestion**.

PIECE	THE OBVIOUS USE	A YEAR 3 SUGGESTION
hoop	jump in	roll it and travel through the moving hole
bench	walk along	sit, turn, slide off into a shape
rope / ribbon	skip	draw a large slow letter in the air and follow it
mat	land on it	use it as a shore: one movement on, one movement off
ball	throw	keep it on a body part that is not a hand

You still adapt, as you did in 1.4. The new work is letting the object choose the idea, then keeping control of the idea it chose.



The hoop as a moving doorway. Rowan is not jumping in. She is timing her travel through a circle that will not wait. Look at her eyes: they are on the hoop, not on the camera.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose one piece of apparatus. Write the obvious use, then invent two others.

USE	WHAT WE DID	STILL IN CONTROL?
the obvious one	_____	_____
idea 2	_____	_____
idea 3	_____	_____

- 2 Keep the best idea. Join it to a starting shape and a finishing shape.
- 3 Swap apparatus with another pair. Use **their** object with **your** idea, and notice what has to change.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Two pieces of apparatus at once. The sequence must use both, and must not be "do something on A, then something on B". The join is the invention.

🚩 STAY SAFE

Ribbon and rope stay below head height when other people are near. A rolling hoop has a watcher whose only job is to stop it reaching a wall or a shin.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Answering a task with your body

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The task cards in this topic, or the teacher's voice. Work in twos or threes.

✦ WARM UP

On "go", make a wide shape. On "change", make a narrow one. On "link", travel from one to the other in four counts.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The teacher says, "Cross the meadow without your feet making a sound."

Some children tiptoe and still thump. Sorrel goes so slowly that the landing of each foot is a separate decision. She is the only quiet one.

► Learn

A **task** is a problem with more than one right answer.

Year 3 tasks are short:

- cross without a sound
- travel at three different heights
- take the ball from here to there without using your hands
- make a sequence that would fit under a low branch
- start and finish in the same shape, with something surprising in the middle

First you answer a task you are given. Then you write a task of your own and give it to a partner. Writing the task is the harder half, because a vague task ("do something creative") cannot be answered well.



Crossing without a sound. Sorrel's feet are arriving one at a time, toes first. The rest of the class is already on the other side, and louder.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow's task for the three: *Get a beanbag from this hoop to that hoop. The beanbag may not be carried in a hand.*

Pip tucks it under his chin. Bramble balances it on his head. Tuft rolls it with his nose. Three answers, one task, none of them wrong.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Answer this task: **travel from one line to the other, changing level twice, without stopping.** Draw or write what you did.

MY ANSWER TO THE GIVEN TASK

- 2 Write a task of your own. It must be one sentence, and a partner must be able to do it in under a minute.

My task:

- 3 Give your task to a partner. Watch their answer. Did the task say enough, or did you have to explain it?
 - ☐ the task was enough on its own
 - ☐ I had to add a rule once they had started
 - ☐ their answer surprised me, and still fitted

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Answer the same task three ways. Keep the one that surprised you, not the one that was easiest.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Moving like a storm, moving like a leaf

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A drum, a tambourine or a clapped pulse. Optional ribbon or scarf. Groups of four for a short shared phrase.

✦ WARM UP

The teacher plays two contrasting sounds: a rumble and a tick. Match the sound with your whole body, not only your feet.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"Move like the wind," says the teacher.

The class runs in circles, which is what "wind" usually produces.

Willow says, from the post, "Wind is not only fast. Sometimes it lifts. Sometimes it drops. Sometimes it goes around a thing instead of through it."

► Learn

A **mood** or a **theme** is not a costume. It is a set of dynamics and pathways that belong together.

THEME	SPEED	LEVEL	FORCE	PATHWAY
storm	sudden changes	mixed, often low then high	strong	zigzag, broken
leaf	slow, then a quick drop	falling through levels	light	curved, drifting
tide	steady, repeating	low	firm then soft	to and fro on one line
seed growing	very slow	low to high	starts light, ends strong	almost no travel

You are not acting the weather. You are borrowing its dynamics. A child who mimes rain with their fingers is acting. A child whose whole body keeps changing speed the way a storm does is composing.

This is also where **dance** and **gymnastics** sit in Year 3. A gymnastic phrase cares about clear shapes and safe landings. A dance phrase cares about the mood holding all the way through. You will build one of each.



Storm and leaf in the same meadow. On the left, Rowan is low and sudden. On the right, Tuft is high, light and drifting. Same grass. Opposite dynamics.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

In a Portuguese storm on the Estoril coast the wind does not blow at one speed. It gusts. That is why "move like a storm" done at one fast pace is the wrong picture. The interesting part is the change.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose **storm** or **leaf**. Fill the four dynamics before you move.

DIAL

I WILL SET IT TO

Speed

Level

Force

DIAL	I WILL SET IT TO
Pathway	

- 2 Build an eight-count phrase. Counts 1 to 4 are the beginning of the weather. Counts 5 to 8 are what it does next.
- 3 In fours, join your phrases so the group is one storm or one leaf, not four people next to each other. Still shapes may be shared. Travelling must not collide.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Perform the phrase once as a dance (the mood must hold) and once as gymnastics (every shape must be clear enough to photograph). Same movements. Different job. A watcher says which version they saw, without being told.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

The storm that stayed fast the whole way was just a run. The storm that went still for two counts in the middle was a storm.

The meadow dance

One short composed phrase for the Wide Meadow.

THE PHRASE IS FINISHED WHEN	IT IS NOT FINISHED WHEN
it answers a task you can write in one sentence	you cannot say what the task was
it uses one piece of apparatus as an idea	the apparatus is only something to jump over
a watcher can name the mood	it is "just movements"

THE PHRASE IS FINISHED WHEN

you can perform it twice the same

IT IS NOT FINISHED WHEN

it only works once, by luck



The meadow dance. Four friends, one phrase, a ribbon drawing a curve the bodies then follow. Nobody is in a lane.

Our phrase

THE TASK OUR PHRASE ANSWERS

Mood or theme, and the apparatus it needed:

STARTING SHAPE

FINISHING SHAPE

How did Unit 3 go?

I invented a movement that was not a taught run, skip or jump.

I used apparatus as an idea, not only as a thing to get over.

I answered a given task, then wrote a clear task of my own.

My phrase had a mood a watcher could name.

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I found a movement nobody had demonstrated.
- ☐ I let a hoop, bench, rope or mat suggest the next idea.
- ☐ I can write a one-sentence task a partner can answer.
- ☐ I can hold a mood for a whole short phrase.

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 4 • TEAM FIELD

4

Taking part

Year 2 taught you to wear a bib and stay in your half.
Year 3 asks you to have a job in the team, and to do it
when it is not your turn with the ball.

On the Team Field you join in properly, know your role, work at a goal on your own, take a turn at leading, name a strength, and listen before you move.



Picture 4.0 Six friends on a marked patch of grass. One has the ball. The other five are all doing a job: two supporting, one defending a gate, one waiting to come on, one watching the whole field. Taking part is not the same as touching the ball.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ join in alone, in a shared space, and in a small team
- ✓ name your own role and someone else's
- ✓ work towards a movement goal without being chased
- ✓ take a short turn at leading, then hand the lead on
- ✓ say one thing you do well and one thing to practise
- ✓ listen to a teammate and change what you do next

○ Come out to the track

Think of the last team game you played.

How much of it were you actually in, and how much of it were you waiting near the ball hoping it would come?

This unit is about the first of those.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1**Joining in properly****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

One soft ball or beanbag per six, four cones, space to run a small relay.

✦ WARM UP

Walk the edge of the Team Field. Each time you pass someone, change direction so you do not bunch. The warm-up fails if more than two people occupy the same two-metre patch.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

A six-person relay. Pip runs the first leg beautifully, then sits down.

The other five still have to run. The team is slower because its fastest member has left the job.

► Learn

Involvement has four homes, and Year 3 asks for all of them.

HOME	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
alone	you can do the skill when nobody is watching
sharing space	you move around other bodies without colliding
whole group	you are in the circle, the relay, the warm-up, not beside it
playing with others	you pass, receive, support, reset

Sitting down after your good bit is leaving. So is hovering next to the skilled person hoping to be in the photograph.

Modified games in this unit stay small: 3 v 3 football, 3 v 3 meadow ball, a four-person striking-and-fielding game, a shuttle relay. They stay small so everybody has a job.



The relay that still has five people in it. Pip has handed the baton and is already watching the next runner's start, not walking off.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Run a four-leg shuttle relay. After your leg, write what you did **next**.

After I ran I

- 2 Play 3 v 3 football with a soft ball, two small cone goals, no goalkeeper. After two minutes, tick every home you were actually in.
 - ☐ alone (I could do the kick or the stop)
 - ☐ sharing space (I did not bunch)
 - ☐ whole group (I was in every restart)
 - ☐ playing with others (I passed or received at least once)
- 3 Name one moment you were only near the ball, not in the game.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Play the same 3 v 3 with a new rule: **the player who last touched the ball may not score**. You have to join in as a passer or a supporter, or the team cannot finish.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

Your job, and everybody else's

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Bibs in two colours, one ball, two cone goals. 4 v 4 or 3 v 3 plus two "floaters" who play for whoever has the ball.

✦ WARM UP

Without a ball, walk to the place your role will stand. Freeze. Look around. If two people froze in the same place, one of you has the wrong job.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Mini-basketball, four a side, a low hoop or a hoop held by the teacher.

Everybody follows the ball. The hoop is empty. The pass has nowhere to go.

► Learn

A **role** is the job you have agreed to do for this game, not your personality.

ROLE	IN A SMALL INVASION GAME	IN STRIKING AND FIELDING
attacker	find space, receive, pass or shoot	the batter
supporter	be a place a pass can go	the next batter, ready

ROLE	IN A SMALL INVASION GAME	IN STRIKING AND FIELDING
defender	stand between ball and target	cover a zone, not a friend
watcher / timer	the three jobs from Unit 1	the same

You keep the role long enough to get good at it, then you rotate. Staying attacker all year is not leadership. It is hogging.



Four jobs, one hoop. One squirrel under the hoop, one out wide, one bringing the ball, one defending the line. The picture only works because they are not all in the same place.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow writes the four jobs on a card and hands it over before the first throw. Nobody is allowed to start until each player can point to their own name and their own job.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the role you will play first, and one thing that role must do.

My role: _____

My job is to

2 Play three minutes. Rotate. Write the role you found hardest, and why.

3 Point to one teammate and say their role out loud, correctly, while the game is still going. If you cannot, you have been watching only the ball.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Play 3 v 3 with **silent roles**. No talking. The only way a teammate knows you are supporting is that you are standing in space. After the game, ask them whether they knew.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Working at it on your own

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A target (hoop, skittle, chalk circle), a ball or beanbag, a stopwatch, your pencil. Alone, then a watcher only if you ask for one.

✦ WARM UP

Twenty controlled catches against a wall, counting out loud. If you drop one, the count goes back to zero. The warm-up is the goal.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The teacher sets a throwing target and walks away to another group.

Pip throws twice, misses, and waits to be told what to do next.

Bramble stays. He moves one step closer, tries again, and keeps a tally.

► Learn

An **agreed goal** is a target you can measure without a teacher standing over you.

A YEAR 3 GOAL	NOT A GOAL
8 catches out of 10 from this line	get better
hold a one-foot balance to 12	try hard
dribble through five cones with no touch	be like a footballer
improve my own last score by one	beat the person next to me

Working independently means: you know the goal, you know how to tell, and you keep going when nobody is watching. It is the Unit 1 practice idea, now without the three jobs unless you choose them.



Bramble and the tally. The teacher is not in the picture. The notebook is.

• YOUR TURN

1 Write one measurable goal for the next five minutes.

Goal:

How I will tell:

2 Work at it. Record three attempts.

ATTEMPT	SCORE OR COUNT	WHAT I CHANGE NEXT
1		
2		
3		

- 3 Did you need the teacher, or did the goal hold you?
- ☐ the goal was enough
 - ☐ I wandered when nobody was looking
 - ☐ I asked for a watcher, which still counts as independent if I asked

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Set a goal that takes the whole of a break to finish, not a lesson. Bring back the tally. A goal you only do when the lesson is watching you is not yet yours.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Taking a turn at leading

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A group of four, one ball or one piece of apparatus, two minutes on the clock.

✦ WARM UP

The current leader walks a pathway. The other three follow, two steps behind, matching speed. On the clap, the back person becomes the leader.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan loves leading. She keeps the bib.

The other three get very good at following and no better at deciding.

► Learn

Leading, at Year 3, is a short job you hand on.

A Year 3 leader does four things, then stops:

- 1 says the goal in one sentence
- 2 shows once, not twice
- 3 starts the group
- 4 watches one thing, then gives the lead to the next person

Leading is not being the loudest, and it is not doing the skill for everybody else. If you are still holding the ball at the end of your two minutes, you were performing, not leading.



The bib changing hands. Rowan is giving it to Tuft. Look at her other paw: it is empty. The ball is already on the ground between them.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Each person leads for two minutes. Write the one-sentence goal you gave.

My goal as leader:

2 After your turn, tick what you actually did.

- ☐ I said the goal
- ☐ I showed once
- ☐ I started them
- ☐ I handed the lead on, on time

3 As a follower, write one useful thing your leader did, and one thing that wasted time.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Lead a group that includes one person who was not listening at the start. Your job is to get them in without stopping the others. Shouting their name is the weak answer.

🚩 STAY SAFE

A leader may not invent a lift, a flip or a race into a wall. If you are not sure the task is safe, you ask the teacher before you start the group.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.5

What I am good at, what is next

📋 THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The look-what-I-can-do list from Unit 1, a pencil, a partner who will tell the truth.

✦ WARM UP

Perform one thing you already know you do well. Then perform one thing you avoid. Notice how your body feels different in the second one.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"What are you good at?"

"Everything," says Pip.

"Nothing," says Tuft.

Both answers are unusable. One is showing off. One is hiding.

► Learn

A **strength** is a movement quality you can name and a watcher can see.

NAMED STRENGTH	NAMED NEXT STEP
I land still	I need a stronger take-off
I find space	I need to pass earlier
I hold a balance	I need to travel into it
I give clear feedback	I need to take my own turn at moving

You are not ranking yourself against the class. You are comparing yourself to the last time you did this movement. That is the only comparison this book allows.



Two lists, one hedgehog. Tuft has written one strength and one next step. The strength list is not longer. That is honest, not modest.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Write one strength a watcher has seen, not one you hope is true.

Strength:

- 2 Write the next step. It must be smaller than the strength, and practisable this week.

Next:

- 3 Your partner confirms or corrects both lines. If they cannot see the strength, it is not yet a strength.

Partner's note:

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Pip is quick. That is true. His next step is not "be quicker". It is "keep the quick until the landing is still."

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.6

Listening, then moving

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A small-sided game (3 v 3 football, or 3 v 3 meadow ball), and a rule that talking happens only at the restart.

✦ WARM UP

In pairs, A says a three-word instruction (*go left now*). B moves. Swap. If B moves before A has finished the third word, the go does not count.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan shouts "pass" five times.

Pip does not pass. He did not hear "pass". He heard noise.

On the next restart she says, looking at him, "Pip. Square. Now."

He passes.

► Learn

Listening in a game is a skill. It has three parts.

- 1 look at the person speaking
- 2 take the one useful word

3 change what you do next

If nothing changes, you did not listen. You only heard.

Useful Year 3 calls are short: *time*, *man on*, *square*, *turn*, *keep*. A sentence in the middle of a 3 v 3 arrives too late.



One word, then the pass. Rowan is looking at Pip, not at the sky. Pip's head is up. The ball is leaving.

• YOUR TURN

1 Play three minutes. You may speak only at restarts, and only in three words.

A call I gave:

Did anything change? _____

2 Play three more minutes. You may speak during play, but only one word.

The word that worked: _____

3 After the game, tell your partner one call you ignored, and why.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Play a whole point with no calls at all. Communication has to be where you stand. After the point, say whether the silence made the supporting easier or harder.

The team games

One small-sided game that uses everything on the Team Field.

THE GAME IS WORKING WHEN	IT IS NOT WORKING WHEN
every player can name their role	three people are chasing the ball
the lead has changed at least once	one person is still organising at the end
at least one call changed a movement	the calls were only noise
each player can name a strength and a next step	the talk is only about who won



The team games. A 3 v 3 on a small marked pitch, two cone goals, everybody in a place that makes sense. Nobody is sitting on the fence.

Our team-games card

BEFORE WE START

The game we will play:

My first role:

Our one-sentence tactic from Unit 2:

How did Unit 4 go?

I joined in after my own good bit, not only during it.

I can name my role and one other person's.

I worked at a goal I could measure without being chased.

I led for a short turn and handed the lead on.

I named a real strength and a smaller next step.

I listened, and something in my movement changed.

☐ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ I stayed in the game after I had had my turn.
- ☐ I knew my job when I did not have the ball.
- ☐ I can work at a goal on my own.
- ☐ I can lead for two minutes and then stop.
- ☐ I can say what I do well and what is next.
- ☐ I can use one useful word, not five shouted ones.

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 5 • KIT SHED

5

Taking responsibility

The Team Field taught you a job in a game. The Kit Shed teaches you the jobs that keep other people safe enough to play it.

Here you share space and kit, move safely on purpose, play fairly, ask for help at the right moment, and say something useful afterwards.



Picture 5.0 The kit shed door is open. Cones, hoops, a pair of plastic hockey sticks and a bag of soft balls are being carried out in two trips, not dragged in one. Bramble has the door. Tuft has the bag. Nobody is already playing.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ share space and equipment, take turns, and cooperate without being told each time
- ✓ move and use kit safely because you chose to, not because you were caught
- ✓ show fair play when it costs you something
- ✓ ask for help at the right moment, and give it
- ✓ give short, kind, useful feedback, and receive it without arguing

○ Come out to the track

A game can look exciting and still be unsafe.

This unit is the one that makes the other five units possible.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.1**Sharing a space and a set of kit****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Not enough of something: four hockey sticks for six, or two racquets for five, or one bench for eight. The shortage is the lesson.

✦ WARM UP

Put the kit out. Count it. Count the people. Say the number that is missing, out loud, before anyone starts.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Six children. Four plastic hockey sticks.

The first four grab. The last two wait, then wander off.

The game of six becomes a game of four, and two people practise nothing.

► Learn

Sharing is a system, not a mood.

SYSTEM	HOW IT WORKS
rotate on a signal	two minutes with the stick, then pass it across
one kit, three jobs	mover, feeder, collector: the stick changes with the job
stations	the short-of-kit activity is one station, not the whole lesson
paired kit	two people, one racquet, the rally is the point

Taking turns is the visible half. The invisible half is leaving the kit in a state the next person can use: ball returned, stick head down, hoop flat.



Four sticks, six friends, a system. Two are moving, two are feeding, two are collecting. Everybody has a job. The sticks are not the only resource.

• YOUR TURN

1 Write the sharing system you will use today, before the first go.

Our system:

2 Play it for six minutes. Tally how many turns each person actually had.

NAME	TURNS
me	_____
partner	_____
the person who usually waits	_____

3 Was the kit left ready for the next person? Tick what you did.

- ☐ ball or puck returned
- ☐ stick or racquet down, not swinging
- ☐ space clear for the next group

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Run the same activity with **one fewer** piece of kit than last time. The system has to get better. If two people drop out, the system failed.

🚩 STAY SAFE

Hockey sticks and racquets stay below the waist until the teacher has said the space is clear. A stick is carried vertically, head down, walking, never running.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.2

Safe on purpose, not by luck

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The space you will actually use, checked. A throw-and-catch activity and a landing activity, so two different risks sit side by side.

✦ WARM UP

Walk the boundary. Point to three things that could hurt somebody (a bag, a bench corner, a wet patch). Move or mark each one before the first activity.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip throws a hard ball at a target on a wall. Behind the target is a door.

Nobody is coming through the door. Until somebody is.

► Learn

Safety in this book is a set of checks you do on purpose.

Before a lesson:

- 1 space: what is on the floor, what is behind the target, where is the wall
- 2 kit: does it bounce as expected, is the stick intact, is the mat thick enough
- 3 bodies: shoes that stay on, no jewellery that catches, hair that does not whip into eyes
- 4 stop: everyone knows the stop signal, and has practised freezing on it
- 5 voice: pain, dizziness or a bump is reported. Not later. Now.

During throwing: you look where the ball will go, including behind the target.

During landing: you see the mat before you leave the ground. During striking: you know where the follow-through will travel.

Luck is not a plan. A lesson that "went fine" without the checks was still unsafe. You just were not unlucky yet.



Looking behind the target. Pip has the ball. Bramble is pointing at the door beyond the wall target. The throw has not happened yet.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The NHS advises a short warm-up before exercise so the body is ready and the risk of a pulled muscle is lower. A cold sprint from the changing room into a race is the opposite of that advice. The warm-up is a safety habit, not a delay before the fun.

• YOUR TURN

1 Do the five checks for the space you are in. Write the one that needed a change.

2 Throw at a target. Name what is behind it.

Behind the target:

- 3 Practise the stop signal. From a jog, freeze in two beats. Repeat from a throw. Repeat from a balance. The stop has to work in all three.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Invent a new activity with a partner. Before you play it, write its one extra risk and what you will do about it. If you cannot name the risk, you may not start.

🚩 STAY SAFE

Footwear stays on. Water is for the pause, not while moving. If something hurts in a new way, you stop and you tell. You are not being brave by hiding it.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.3

What fair play actually means

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A small-sided game with a clear scoring system: 3 v 3, or a striking-and-fielding game with batting turns.

✦ WARM UP

Play "make it fair": start a 2 v 4 on purpose, play twenty seconds, then fix the numbers yourselves without the teacher doing it.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The ball is out. Pip knows it is out. He picks it up and plays on, and scores.

His team cheer. The other team go quiet.

The score is now a lie.

► Learn

Fair play is what you do when it costs you.

FAIR	NOT FAIR, EVEN IF NOBODY SAW
you say the ball was out	you wait to see if the teacher saw
you rotate the batter	you keep batting because you are good at it
you accept the watcher's call	you argue until the call changes
you play the person, not their size	you only pass to your friend

Collaboration is the other half: you want the game to keep working for everyone in it, including the other team. A game that only works if you win is a poor game.



The ball is out, and Pip is saying so. His paw is up. The game has stopped. Look at the other team: they are not arguing, because they do not have to.

• YOUR TURN

1 Play five minutes. Keep two tallies: scores, and fair-play moments.

	OUR TEAM	OTHER TEAM
scores	_____	_____
times someone told the truth when it cost them	_____	_____

2 Name one moment you could have cheated, and what you did.

3 At the end, shake hands or bump elbows. Then say one true thing about how the other team played.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Play a game where **you** are the watcher, not a player. Call the lines. After the game, both teams say whether the calls felt fair. A watcher who only calls against one team has a problem.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.4

Asking for help at the right moment

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A task just on the edge of what the group can do: a long sequence, a 4 v 4, or apparatus that needs two people to carry.

✦ WARM UP

In pairs, carry a bench the agreed way (two people, talking, walking). Put it down together. That is already asking for help, done well.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft cannot get the hang of a catch on the move.

He says nothing for ten goes. Then he throws the ball into the corner and sits down.

The help he needed was on go two.

► Learn

Asking for help is a timing skill.

Ask too soon and you never find out what you can do. Ask too late and you have practised the wrong thing ten times, or someone has been left out, or a bench has

been dragged by one pair of arms.

Good moments to ask:

- after two honest attempts, not after zero and not after twenty
- before you lift or carry something that needs two
- when a teammate is stuck on a rule and the game has stopped
- when something hurts

Good ways to ask, at Year 3:

- "Watch my catching hand, not the throw."
- "Can you feed me a slower one?"
- "I need a second person on this bench."

"I cannot do it" is not a request. It is a door closing.



The right moment. Tuft has tried twice. He is looking at Rowan and pointing at his catching paw. The ball is still in play, in her hands, ready for a slower feed.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Attempt a catch on the move twice. Then ask for one specific change.

What I asked for:

- 2 Be the person who is asked. Give the help, then step back. Helping is not taking over the turn.
- 3 Carry or set out one piece of apparatus that needs two people. Write who asked, and how.
-

▲ **TRACK CHALLENGE**

Notice a teammate who needs help and has not asked. Offer one specific thing ("shall I feed slower?") and accept a no. Offering is not insisting.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.5

Saying something useful

■ **THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

A partner, a short sequence or a small game, a pencil.

✦ **WARM UP**

Watch one standing jump. Say nothing. Then say one sentence. Compare which of those two was kinder. Silence is not always kind.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"That was rubbish," says Pip, grinning, as if a grin made it a joke.

Tuft does not jump again.

► Learn

Feedback at Year 3 has three rules.

- 1 about the movement, not the person
- 2 one thing, not a list
- 3 useful: the person can do something with it on the next go

USEFUL	NOT USEFUL
your eyes went down on the catch	you are bad at catching
keep the stick below your waist	be careful
that pass found the space	well done (says nothing to repeat)
you stopped between hop and jump	messy

Receiving feedback is the other skill: you try the thing, or you ask a question. You do not explain why the watcher is wrong. The watcher is a mirror, as in Unit 1. Mirrors are not argued with.

Appreciation is shorter still: "that pass," or "you waited for me." Named, not sugary.



One sentence, then the next go. Willow has closed the notebook. Tuft is already setting up to jump again. The feedback has landed when the next go starts.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch a partner's sequence. Write one useful sentence, then say it.
- 2 Receive one sentence. Do the next go with that one change. Tick if you used it.
 - ☐ I used it
 - ☐ I argued
 - ☐ I nodded and did the same thing
- 3 End with one appreciation that names the thing, not the person.

✱ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Well done is a sweet. It tastes fine and it does not tell you what to cook tomorrow. "Your landing stayed still" is supper.

The kit-shed games

A small game that only works if the five responsibilities hold.

THE GAME IS ALLOWED TO START WHEN	IT WAITS
kit and space have been shared on a system	four people have a stick and two do not
the five safety checks are done	someone is already throwing
a fair-play watcher is named	both teams plan to argue
carrying needs two, and has two	a bench is sliding on its own



Ready to start. Kit out, space clear, two on the bench, a watcher named. The first throw has not happened. That is what responsibility looks like.

How did Unit 5 go?

I shared kit on a system, not by grabbing.

I did the safety checks on purpose, before the first go.

I told the truth when it cost my team a point.

I asked for help after two tries, specifically.

I gave one useful sentence, and I used one I was given.

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I can share kit so the person who usually waits still has a turn.
- ☐ I can name what is behind a target before I throw.
- ☐ I can stop a game to tell the truth about a line.
- ☐ I can ask for one specific change.
- ☐ I can give feedback a partner can use on the next go.

OVER THE PAGE

A new ground. Same six friends.

UNIT 6 • LONG HILL

6

Healthy bodies

The other grounds taught you what a body can do.
This one teaches you what a body is doing while it
does it, and how to look after it afterwards.

On the Long Hill you notice the changes that come with moving, name the parts that are working, choose a sensible intensity, know today's limit, warm up and cool down on purpose, and eat and drink for a moving body.



Picture 6.0 The hill behind the meadow, late afternoon. The six are walking up it, not sprinting. Bramble has the watch. Pip's mouth is open, not because he is talking. They are going far enough to feel it, and slowly enough to keep going.

✓ ON THIS GROUND YOU WILL

- ✓ notice and name what changes in your body during activity
- ✓ name the body parts doing the work, and why
- ✓ choose a sensible intensity and work towards it
- ✓ recognise today's limit, and the extra risk of a new context
- ✓ warm up before, and cool down afterwards
- ✓ name simple parts of a healthy plate for a moving day

○ Come out to the track

Put two fingers on the thumb-side of your wrist.

Sit still for twenty seconds. Then stand up and jump for twenty seconds. Feel again.

That difference is the subject of this unit. It was happening in Units 1 to 5. You are going to notice it on purpose.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.1**What changes while you move****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

A way to time twenty seconds, a pencil, space to move from still to jogging.

✦ WARM UP

Sit. Breathe normally. Notice the breath without changing it. Then walk. Then jog on the spot. Sit again. The warm-up is the experiment.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

After a long tag game Pip says, "I am dying."

He is not dying. His face is pink, he is breathing faster, he is warmer, and he wants water. Those are four changes, and they have names.

► Learn

During activity, a healthy body makes changes you can feel.

CHANGE YOU CAN NOTICE	WHAT IT IS FOR
breathing faster	more air for working muscles
heart beating faster	more blood carrying oxygen
feeling warmer	muscles making heat
skin a little pinker or sweatier	getting rid of some of that heat
muscles feeling used	they have been working

These changes are expected. They are not an emergency. An emergency is pain that is new and sharp, dizziness, or not being able to speak a short sentence. Those you report.

The point of noticing is so you can tell "this is working" from "this is too much today".



After the hill, not on it. Pip is sitting on the grass, pink, smiling, water bottle in both paws. He can talk. That is the difference between used and in trouble.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Children and young people aged 5 to 18 should aim for an average of at least 60 minutes of moderate or vigorous activity a day across the week. That is the UK Chief Medical Officers' guideline, also given by the NHS. It is an average across the week, not a punishment timer on every afternoon.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Sit, then walk, then jog, each for twenty seconds. Tick what you notice.

SITTING

WALKING

JOGGING

breathing faster

warmer

can still talk in a sentence

2 After the jog, can you say a whole sentence without gasping?

- ☐ yes, easily
- ☐ yes, but I have to pause
- ☐ no

3 Write one change that is expected, and one that would make you stop and tell.

Expected:

Stop and tell:

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Do a one-minute shuttle. At 20, 40 and 60 seconds, hold up one finger if talking is easy, two if it is possible, three if it is not. That is your own intensity scale. You will need it in 6.3.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.2

Naming the parts doing the work

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Space to jump, throw, balance and sprint a few metres. A partner to watch which parts move.

✦ WARM UP

Slowly: circle the ankles, bend and straighten the knees, swing the arms, turn the shoulders, nod the head gently. Name each part as you go.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"My legs hurt," says Sorrel after a throwing practice.

Willow, who was watching, says: "You threw with your arm. Your legs were standing still. If they hurt, something else was going on."

► Learn

Different activities ask different parts to work.

ACTIVITY	PARTS DOING MOST OF THE WORK	WHY
sprint	hips, thighs, calves, arms	they drive and they balance the drive
jump and land	thighs, calves, feet, hips	they push you up and then absorb the down
throw	shoulder, arm, trunk, opposite leg	the throw starts from the ground, not from the hand
catch	eyes, hands, elbows, feet	the feet get you to the ball; the hands finish it
balance	feet, ankles, core (the middle)	small corrections keep you still
kick	hip, thigh, foot, standing leg	the standing leg is doing as much as the kicking one

You do not need adult muscle names. You do need to point to the part and say why it is busy. "My arm" is a start. "My standing leg, because it held me up while the other one kicked" is Year 3.



The standing leg. Sorrel is kicking a soft ball. Look at the other leg: it is planted, slightly bent, doing the unspectacular half of the kick.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Do a jump. Point to two parts that worked on the way up, and two that worked on the landing.

Up:

Landing:

- 2 Do a throw. Your watcher points to the part they think started the throw. Do you agree?
 - ☐ yes, it started from the ground
 - ☐ I only used my arm
 - ☐ we disagree, so we try again slowly

- 3 Name the part that gets forgotten in your favourite activity.

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Teach a Year 2 child (or a partner pretending) which two parts to think about in a landing. Use your hands, not a lecture.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.3

How hard is hard enough

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Cones for a small circuit: agility (side-steps through cones), speed (a short sprint), stamina (a longer jog around the field), coordination (ball bounce and catch), balance (a line). A water bottle.

✦ WARM UP

Walk the whole circuit once, naming each station. No racing. This is a map, not a race.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The circuit begins. Pip sprints station one, sprints station two, and cannot finish station three.

Bramble starts slower, talks in sentences the whole way, and is still moving at the end.

► Learn

Intensity is how hard the activity is for you, today.

Year 3 has three useful levels, felt not calculated:

LEVEL	HOW IT FEELS	EXAMPLE
easy	I can sing	walking the boundary, a slow balance
moderate	I can talk in sentences	jogging, a game of 3 v 3, a dance phrase
vigorous	I can say a few words only	a short sprint, a long tag, the hill at pace

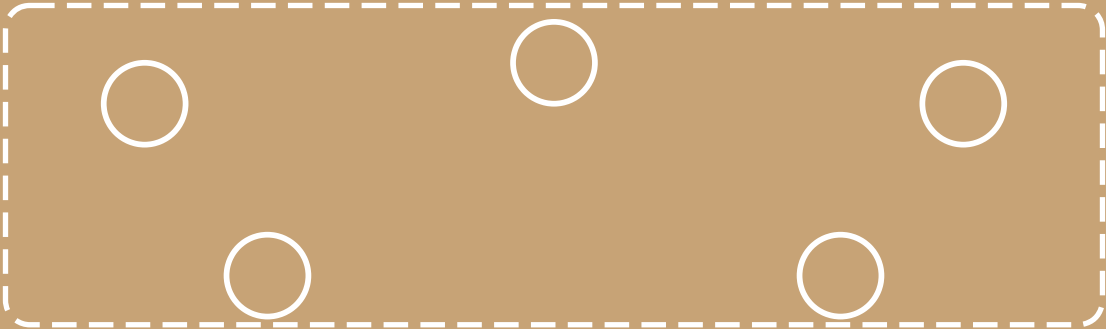
Hard enough depends on the job. A sprint is supposed to be vigorous, and short. A warm-up is supposed to be easy, then moderate. A stamina station that you cannot finish because you treated it like a sprint was the wrong intensity, not a weak body.

Fitness at Year 3 is this circuit, not an adult gym programme. Agility, speed, stamina, coordination, balance, bodyweight strength (a hold, a jump, a crawl) and a little flexibility in the cool-down.



The circuit, not a race. Five stations in a loop on the clay. Bramble is at the long-jog station, talking to Tuft. Pip is already sitting at station three.

GROUND 6.3 · THE LONG-HILL CIRCUIT



Five rings, one loop. You choose the intensity at each ring. The dashed line is the walk between them, and it is part of the work.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Walk the circuit once (easy). Jog it once (moderate). Sprint only the speed station (vigorous). Write how talking felt on each.

LAP	TALKING
walk	
jog	
speed station	

- 2 Choose the intensity the stamina station actually needs, and stay there for two full loops.

I chose: _____

- 3 Tick the parts of fitness you used.

- ☐ stamina (I kept going)
- ☐ agility (I changed direction)

- ☐ speed (a short fast go)
- ☐ coordination (hands and feet together)
- ☐ balance (I held still)
- ☐ strength (a hold or a jump)

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Build a one-minute station of your own that is moderate, not vigorous. A partner has to still be able to talk at the end. If they cannot, you built a sprint and called it something else.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.4

Knowing your own limit today

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A familiar activity and an unfamiliar one (new apparatus, a new surface, a slightly longer distance). Water. Permission to stop.

✦ WARM UP

Do yesterday's easy version of something you know. Notice whether today feels the same.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The class did hopscotch on the playground last week.

Today the same pattern is chalked on grass, slightly wet.

Two children slip. They were not weaker than last week. The ground had changed.

► Learn

A **limit** is not a personality. It is today's combination of sleep, heat, mood, a new surface, new kit, and how much you have already done.

SAME BODY	DIFFERENT RISK
hopscotch on dry playground	hopscotch on wet grass
a throw in the hall	a throw with the sun in your eyes
a balance on a line	a balance on a bench
a jog you always finish	a jog at the end of sports day

Knowing the limit means you can change the task: shorter, slower, a different surface, a rest, a drink. Changing the task is control. Pushing through a new sharp pain is not bravery.



The same hopscotch, new ground. Tuft is on wet grass, taking a smaller hop than he took on the playground. The smaller hop is the intelligent one.

• YOUR TURN

1 Name one thing that is different about today (heat, tiredness, a new space).

2 Change one activity to fit. Write the change.

I made it

3 A partner tries your changed version. Is it still the same skill?

- ☐ yes, just safer or more possible today
- ☐ I accidentally made a different skill
- ☐ I should have changed it more

STAY SAFE

Stop and tell: new sharp pain, dizziness, cannot speak, cannot see clearly, or a bump to the head. The teacher is not annoyed. That is their job.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.5**Before, and afterwards****THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Six minutes at the start, five minutes at the end. The same space you will use for the lesson.

WARM UP

This topic *is* the warm-up. Take it slowly on purpose.

WHAT HAPPENED

The first activity on sports day is a sprint.

Half the class come straight from sitting in a classroom and run.

Two of them pull up in the first ten metres, not because they cannot sprint, because nothing was ready.

► Learn

A **warm-up** gets the body ready. A **cool-down** brings it back.

The NHS publishes a short warm-up of about six minutes before exercise: start easy (marching, heel digs), then move a little more. The point is a gradual rise, not a pretend race.

	WARM-UP	COOL-DOWN
Heart and breathing	rise gradually	fall gradually
Muscles	warmer, easier to move	still moving, then a gentle stretch
Brain	arriving in the lesson	leaving the lesson without a crash
Time	about five to six minutes	a few minutes, not a sit-down

Cooling down lets heart rate and breathing ease, rather than dropping you from a sprint onto a bench. A slow walk and a couple of gentle stretches are enough at Year 3. No forcing a stretch. No bouncing.



The six-minute start. The six friends marching, swinging arms, not yet racing. The hill is still in the background. They will get there.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Lead (or follow) a six-minute warm-up with three parts: easy travel, bigger shapes, then a little faster. Tick as you go.

☐ easy travel

- ☐ bigger shapes
 - ☐ a little faster, still in control
 - 2 After the main activity, walk for two minutes, then hold two gentle stretches you can breathe in. Name them.
-
- 3 Which lesson this week skipped one of these? What happened to the first activity?
-

▲ TRACK CHALLENGE

Write a warm-up for a throwing lesson and a different one for a sprint lesson. They should not be the same, because the body is being asked for different things.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.6

What a moving body needs to eat

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Pictures or words for a simple plate, a water bottle, no food in the hall.

✦ WARM UP

Drink water. Sit. Notice that this is already part of the lesson.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sports afternoon. Pip has not drunk since breakfast. By the second game he has a headache and he is grumpy, which he blames on the other team.

► Learn

A moving body needs **regular meals, water**, and a mix of foods. This is not a diet, and it is not a list of forbidden snacks.

A simple Year 3 plate for an active day:

ON THE PLATE	WHY A MOVING BODY LIKES IT
fruit and vegetables	vitamins, and they help you feel well
bread, rice, pasta, potatoes	energy for the next lesson
beans, fish, eggs, meat or another protein	for growing and repairing
a little dairy, or a fortified other drink	for bones
water	you lose water when you sweat

You do not need to weigh anything. You do need to notice: have I drunk water today, have I eaten something that will last a lesson, am I trying to play on an empty stomach or on a huge one.

Sweets and juice can be part of a week. They are not a warm-up.



Water first. A still life on a bench at the edge of the field: a bottle, an apple, a small roll. No packet as the whole meal. Shade, not full sun.

✦ **DID YOU KNOW?**

The NHS Eatwell Guide is the UK picture of a healthy plate: lots of fruit and vegetables, some starchy food, some protein, some dairy or alternatives, and water as the drink. It is a pattern for a day and a week, not a rule for one lunchbox.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Tick what you have had, or will have, on this moving day.
 - ☐ water
 - ☐ something with energy for a lesson (bread, rice, fruit)
 - ☐ something that helps you grow (beans, egg, fish, meat, or similar)
 - ☐ fruit or vegetables

- 2 Plan the drink for a sports afternoon. How often, and where will the bottle live?
- 3 Name one change that would help *you* on a long active day, not a change for somebody else.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Pip's headache was thirsty, not unfair. The other team had water bottles. That was the whole difference.

STAY SAFE

No sharing bottles. No eating while running. If someone feels faint, they sit, they tell, they sip. Food talk in this book is about having enough, never about bodies looking a certain way.

The long-hill circuit

The whole of Unit 6 in one afternoon: notice, name, choose intensity, respect today's limit, warm up, cool down, drink.

THE AFTERNOON IS HEALTHY WHEN	IT IS NOT
the warm-up happened	the first activity was a sprint from the classroom
someone changed a task to fit today	someone hid a new pain
water was drunk	bottles stayed in bags
the cool-down happened	everyone sat hard at the end and stood up dizzy



The long-hill circuit, finished. The six walking down, not collapsing. Bottles in paws. The hill is behind them and they still look like themselves.

How did Unit 6 go?

I can name expected changes, and the ones I must report.

I can point to the parts doing the work, including the quiet ones.

I can choose easy, moderate or vigorous on purpose.

I can change a task for today's limit or a new surface.

I warm up and I cool down, not only on sports day.

I drink water and I eat for a moving day.

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I know the difference between used and in trouble.
- ☐ I can name the standing leg as well as the kicking one.
- ☐ I can keep a stamina station moderate.
- ☐ I can make a task smaller when the ground has changed.

- ☐ I can lead a short warm-up.
- ☐ I can pack water, not only kit.

Words we used

You used every one of these words on the meadow track.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
practice	Repeating a movement with one thing you are trying to change. The noun: <i>a good practice</i> .
practise	To do that repeating. The verb: <i>I practise my landing</i> .
refine	To make a movement you can already do better, in small steps.
smooth	A movement with no wasted wobble, no extra step and no arm shooting out to save it.
wobble	Any small loss of balance that the body has to correct. Countable, which is why the timer counts them.
sequence	Two or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle.
join	The place where one movement becomes the next. The only new work in a sequence.
dynamics	The way a movement is done: its speed, level, size and force.
speed	How quickly a movement happens. One of the four dials.
level	How high or low the body is: on the toes, upright, or close to the floor.
force	How strong or how light a movement is.
pathway	The shape of the route a body travels: straight, curved or zigzag.
apparatus	The equipment you move on, over and through: benches, mats, hoops, ropes.
adapt	To change small details of a movement so it still works on new ground.
control	Ending a movement where and how you meant to, every time and not by luck.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
coordination	Getting different parts of the body to work together in the right order.
criterion	One thing you have agreed to look at before anybody moves. Plural: criteria.
tactic	The simple plan you use inside the rules of a game.
space	The empty grass a teammate can run into, or pass into.
role	The job you have agreed to do for this game, not your personality.
intensity	How hard the activity is for you, today: easy, moderate or vigorous.
warm-up	The few minutes of easy, then bigger, movement before the real work.
cool-down	The few minutes of slower movement afterwards, so the body eases.
fair play	Telling the truth about the game when it costs you something.
feedback	One useful sentence about the movement, that the next go can use.

The three jobs

JOB	IN ONE LINE
mover	Does the movement, properly, as many times as the task asks.
timer	Counts or times, and says the real number out loud.
watcher	Looks at one thing, and says what they saw, not whether they liked it.

Answers for the year

Answers for Unit 1

Some tasks in this unit have one right answer. Most do not, because a movement task is answered with a body and no two bodies answer it the same way. Where there is no single answer, this page says what a good answer must contain instead. Teachers can mark from the right-hand column without having seen the lesson.

1.1 Making a movement smoother

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, choose a movement and one thing to change	The movement must be one the pupil can already do. The one thing must be about the body , and specific: "land with bent knees", "keep my hands still", "look ahead". Reject "jump better", "be smoother" and "try harder", which name no body part and cannot be watched.
Practise 2, the table of ten goes	Four rows completed, from goes 1, 4, 7 and 10. The watcher's column must describe the one chosen thing each time, not the whole movement. A wobble count is a number, not a word.
Practise 3, which is true	Any of the three boxes may be ticked truthfully. Ticking the third box, "worse, because I got tired", is a correct and useful answer and must not be marked down.
Practise 4, what you would do differently	Accept anything that reduces the load or improves the conditions: fewer goes, a rest between goes, practising earlier in the lesson, a shorter run-up.

1.2 Joining movements together

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the three things that make a practice work	One thing to change · a way to tell · enough goes. All three needed. Accept "a watcher" or "a number" for the second, and "about ten" for the third.
Practise 1, a sequence of three	Three movements chosen from the list, written in the order they will be performed. Two joins marked with an arrow.
Practise 2, the weaker join	A named join, 1 or 2, for each of the three goes, with what went wrong at it. A pupil who writes the whole sequence again instead of naming the join has not done the task.
Practise 3, draw the route	Must use the four marks correctly: a dashed line for the route, a ring at the start and at the finish, a short upright mark at each of the two joins.
Practise 4, ticks	All three may be true. The third, "I could have added a fourth movement", is the strongest evidence that both joins worked, because it means the sequence still had speed at the end.
Track challenge	Passed only when a watcher who has not seen it lists all three movements and both joins without asking a question.

1.3 Fast, slow, high, low

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, four timed goes	Four times recorded, and a yes or no for each on whether the dial was held all the way. Expect the slow go to be the one that fails.
Practise 2, the two furthest apart	Almost always the fast go and the slow go. Any two goes are acceptable if the pupil has read their own times correctly.
Practise 3, the hardest one again	A second time for the same setting. It should be more extreme than the first: slower, or lower. If it is not, the pupil has recorded honestly, which still counts.
Practise 4, match the instruction to the dial	"Like a heavy giant" = force . "As small as a mouse" = size . "So slowly I cannot see you moving" = speed . "On your toes with your arms stretched up" = level .
Go a little further, two dials at once	Accept any pairing with a reason. Fast and small usually sits comfortably; slow and strong is genuinely hard to hold for a full crossing, and noticing that is the point.

1.4 New apparatus, same control

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the four dials	Speed • level • size • force . All four needed, in any order.
Practise 1, add one piece of apparatus	One piece only, named, with where it was placed in the sequence. A pupil who adds three has made a new sequence rather than adapted one.
Practise 2, one detail per go	Three rows, each naming one detail, and a yes or no for stops. Look for the detail getting smaller across the three goes: a shorter run-up, then a deeper knee bend, then a shoulder turn.
Practise 3, which changed most	Any of the three boxes, with the pupil's own apparatus matching their choice. A bench should point to the surface or the height; a hoop should point to the shape of the space.
Practise 4, draw the ground	Rectangle for a bench, circle for a hoop, shaded square for a mat, dashed line for the route. The drawing must match the sequence they actually performed.
Track challenge, swap grounds	Passed when the pupils perform another group's sequence from the drawing alone, and can name the one detail they personally had to change.

The meadow games

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
1 Build it	Three movements, two joins, at least one piece of apparatus, and the ground drawn before anybody moved.
2 Smooth it	Ten goes on one chosen detail, with a wobble count that falls, or an honest note saying why it did not.
3 Set the dials	The whole sequence performed fast and slow, each held from start to finish.
4 Be described	A watcher's written description naming all three movements, both joins, and both dynamics.
5 Compare	The plan and the description placed side by side, with the differences named. Finding a difference is a pass, not a fail. A group that finds none has usually not looked.

Answers for Unit 2

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
2.1 four words	Body parts and actions only. Reject good, bad, nice, messy, sporty.
2.1 remember	One thing to change, a way to tell, enough goes.
2.2 four windows	Action, dynamic, space, relationship. All four named.
2.2 2 v 1	Relationship names who was near whom, and when. Not "they ran about".
2.3 three criteria	Written before the first go. Each is yes/no or a number, about the body or the space.
2.4 rules and tactic	Two rules plus one sentence of plan (find space, pass then move, or similar).
2.4 new rule	The pupil can say what the new rule did to the plan, even if the answer is "it made passing more important".

Answers for Unit 3

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
3.1 three travels	None of them a taught run, skip, hop or jump. Each can be stopped safely.
3.2 apparatus	The obvious use plus two others. At least one treats the object as an idea.
3.3 given task	Level changes twice, no stop. A drawing or a sentence is enough.
3.3 own task	One sentence a partner can do in under a minute without extra explanation.
3.4 mood table	All four dials filled before moving. Storm is not "just fast".

Answers for Unit 4

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
4.1 after the relay	A job: watching the next start, collecting the baton, resetting cones. Not "I sat down".
4.2 role	A named job and one thing that job does when it does not have the ball.
4.3 goal	Measurable: a number or a count, against the pupil's own last attempt.
4.4 leading	All four ticks, including handing the lead on.
4.5 strength / next	Strength a partner can see. Next step smaller than the strength.
4.6 listening	A call of one to three words, and a yes or no for whether anything changed.

Answers for Unit 5

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
5.1 system	Rotate, jobs, or stations. A tally that includes the person who usually waits.
5.2 checks	One named change made before the first go. Behind the target is named.
5.2 stop and tell	New sharp pain, dizziness, cannot speak, bump to the head.
5.3 fair play	A moment that cost a point, named. A true sentence about the other team.
5.4 asking	After two tries, one specific request. Not "I cannot do it".

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
5.5 feedback	About the movement, one thing, usable on the next go.

Answers for Unit 6

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
6.1 changes	Breathing faster, warmer, can still talk: expected. New sharp pain or dizziness: stop and tell.
6.1 60 minutes	An average across the week, not a timer on every afternoon.
6.2 parts	Two parts up, two parts landing. Standing leg named in a kick.
6.3 intensity	Walk = easy (can sing). Jog = moderate (can talk). Sprint = vigorous (few words).
6.4 limit	One thing different about today, and one change to the task.
6.5 warm-up	Three parts: easy travel, bigger shapes, a little faster. Cool-down named.
6.6 plate	Water plus at least two of: energy food, growing food, fruit or vegetables.

Term 1 review

Units 1 and 2. Athletics Day sits at the end of this term.

Show, do not write an essay:

- 1 A practised landing that a watcher can describe in four words.
- 2 A sequence of three with no stop.
- 3 One movement at two dynamics, held all the way.
- 4 A 3 v 3 in which you can name your tactic in one sentence.

A pass is against your own first attempt in September, not against the fastest person in the class.

Term 2 review

Units 3 and 4. Football Day sits at the end of this term.

Show:

- 1 A short phrase that answers a written task and has a mood a watcher can name.
 - 2 One piece of apparatus used as an idea.
 - 3 A role in a small-sided game, said out loud while the game is going.
 - 4 A two-minute turn at leading, then the lead handed on.
-

Term 3 review

Units 5 and 6. Multi-sports Day sits at the end of this term.

Show:

- 1 A sharing system that includes the person who usually waits.
- 2 The five safety checks, done before the first go.
- 3 A fair-play moment that cost you something.
- 4 A warm-up, a chosen intensity, water, and a cool-down.

This is the last ground of the year. The hill is behind you. You still look like yourself.

Where the facts came from

Every fact in a *Did you know?* panel was checked against the source named here. Unit 1 facts were read on 2026-08-10. Units 2 to 6 facts were read on 2026-08-19. Nothing is recalled or estimated.

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.1 <i>Did you know?</i>	Rosa Mota won the Olympic marathon for Portugal in Seoul in 1988 in 2 hours 25 minutes 40 seconds, by 13 seconds; world title Rome 1987; European titles 1982, 1986 and 1990	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rosa_Mota
1.2 <i>Did you know?</i>	The triple jump is a hop, then a step, then a jump, in one continuous run, landing on the take-off foot for the hop and the other foot for the step	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Triple_jump , quoting the World Athletics rule
1.2 <i>Did you know?</i>	Nelson Évora won Olympic gold in the triple jump for Portugal in Beijing in 2008	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nelson_Évora
1.3 <i>Did you know?</i>	A European hare can run at about 70 kilometres an hour, and escapes by outrunning predators in the open	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/European_hare
1.4 <i>Did you know?</i>	A competition gymnastics balance beam is 10 centimetres wide, 5 metres long and 1.25 metres above the floor	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Balance_beam , quoting the FIG Apparatus Norms
2.3 <i>Did you know?</i>	Gymnastics judges work to criteria published before the first athlete competes	FIG Code of Points, published in advance of each cycle
5.2 <i>Did you know?</i>	Warm up before exercise to prevent injury and make the work more effective; a short routine of about six minutes	nhs.uk/live-well/exercise/how-to-warm-up-before-exercising/
6.1 <i>Did you know?</i>	Children aged 5 to 18 should aim for an average of at least 60 minutes of moderate or vigorous activity a day across the week	NHS and UK Chief Medical Officers' physical activity guidelines
6.5 teaching	A warm-up raises heart rate and breathing gradually; a cool-down lets them ease rather than drop	NHS warm-up page; Mayo Clinic, Aerobic exercise: How to warm up and cool down

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
6.6 <i>Did you know?</i>	A healthy plate is a pattern of fruit and vegetables, starchy food, protein, dairy or alternatives, and water	NHS Eatwell Guide

For teachers

This section is written to the teacher, not to the pupil. It is here because every Prime Book carries it, and because a Physical Education book is impossible to run from the pupil pages alone: the tasks assume groups of three, a checked space and apparatus an adult has set out.

What this book is for

The whole book covers all 29 Year 3 Physical Education scheme objectives: Moving Well (1.1 to 1.4), Understanding Movement (2.1 to 2.4), Moving Creatively (3.1 to 3.4), Taking Part (4.1 to 4.6), Taking Responsibility (5.1 to 5.5) and Healthy Bodies (6.1 to 6.6). The Input assessment row, "Test term1, term 2 and term 3", is the three review spreads in the back matter.

It deliberately does **not** re-teach Year 1 fundamental movements. Year 3 assumes them and teaches refining, combining, deciding and looking after.

Modified sports sit inside the units, not as a separate sports textbook: athletics in Unit 1, observation and tactics in Unit 2, gymnastics and dance in Unit 3, football, basketball and striking-and-fielding as small-sided games in Unit 4, hockey and racquet sharing in Unit 5, a fitness circuit in Unit 6.

What Unit 1 is for

Unit 1 covers the four Year 3 *Moving Well* objectives from the Year 3 Physical Education scheme of work: refining basic movement skills through practice (1.1), performing them sequentially (1.2), control and coordination with varied space, speed and dynamics (1.3), and adapting to contexts, apparatus and equipment (1.4).

It deliberately does **not** re-teach the movements themselves. Year 1 taught running, jumping, hopping, skipping, landing, stopping, throwing and balancing, and Year 3 assumes them. If a pupil cannot yet land softly or stop where they meant to, the Year 1 material is the right place to go, not a slower version of this unit.

The pedagogical spine

The unit rests on one move: **the class is split into mover, timer and watcher, and the jobs rotate.** Everything else follows from it.

- It makes the scheme's observation and feedback objectives practisable in Year 3 rather than deferred to a written test.
- It gives every pupil a number or a description that is about their **own** earlier attempt, which is the only comparison this book permits.
- It occupies the two pupils who are not moving, which is what usually goes wrong in a primary Physical Education lesson.

Groups of three are therefore not a suggestion. A pair loses the watcher, and the watcher is where the learning is.

Timing

Four topics and a project fill about six lessons of 45 minutes for most classes. Topic 1.1 is the one to give extra time: ten purposeful repetitions takes longer than teachers expect, and cutting it to four removes the evidence the rest of the unit depends on.

A practical note on the timetable. A lesson that starts at **14:30** in Portugal in September is often the hottest part of the afternoon, and topic 1.3 asks pupils to hold a fast setting for a full crossing. Where the hall is warm or the outdoor ground is in full sun, run 1.3 in a morning slot and keep the afternoon for 1.1, which is mostly standing still and watching.

Assessment

Assess from the *Look what I can do* list and the project's step 5 comparison, not from the times. A slow pupil who holds a dial exactly where they put it has met 1.3. A fast pupil who cannot slow down has not.

The Input names three assessment points across the year, one per term. Those become three review spreads in the complete book and are not part of this unit.

Adaptations

- **Distances, heights and timings are all adjustable.** The objective is control, not size. Shorten the lane, lower the apparatus, allow a longer run-up.
- **A pupil who cannot travel** takes the same four dials into a seated or supported movement: an arm pathway can be fast, slow, high, low, large, small, strong or light exactly as a run can.
- **A pupil who cannot write** dictates the watcher's description to a partner, or draws the ground instead. The description matters; the handwriting does not.
- **Apparatus is set out and tested by an adult**, always. The orange *Stay safe* panel in 1.4 is written to the pupil, but the responsibility is the teacher's.

What usually goes wrong, and what to do about it

Six things go wrong in this unit in almost every class. None of them is a sign that the unit is too hard, and five of the six are the lesson working rather than failing.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE	WHAT IS ACTUALLY HAPPENING	WHAT TO DO
A pupil does ten repetitions that all look the same	They are repeating, not practising. Nothing was chosen to change	Send them back to step 3 of <i>How every task runs</i> : say the one thing out loud, in one short sentence, before the next go
The watcher says "that was good"	The commonest failure in the unit, and the hardest to break. Judging is easier than describing	Give the watcher one body part to look at and nothing else. Hands. Knees. Feet. Take the whole movement away from them

WHAT YOU WILL SEE	WHAT IS ACTUALLY HAPPENING	WHAT TO DO
The timer's numbers drift kinder as the lesson goes on	They are trying to be encouraging, and they have not yet understood that the number is the mover's evidence	Read the <i>Did you know?</i> on the ground-rules page together. A kind number is a useless number
A pupil is much slower than the rest and knows it	Almost always a pupil comparing across the class, which this book never asks for	Point at their own first go. Every comparison in this unit is against their own earlier attempt, and that is not a soft option: it is harder to beat yourself
Fixing one join in 1.2 makes a second join fall apart	The second fault was hiding behind the first stop. This is normal and it is worth saying so out loud	Attempt 2 of the worked example in 1.2 is exactly this. It is progress, not going backwards
A smooth floor sequence collapses the moment a bench appears in 1.4	Adaptation has not been practised, which is precisely what 1.4 is for	Shorten the run-up first, before anything else. It is the single change that fixes most of them

If you only have three lessons

Where time is short, teach **1.1 and 1.2 properly** and treat 1.3 and 1.4 as one combined lesson. Do not cut 1.1: it carries the practice method that every later topic depends on, and a class that has not done ten purposeful repetitions has no evidence to reason from in 1.2, 1.3 or 1.4.

If the hall is unavailable, all four topics run outdoors on any marked ground. Only 1.4 needs apparatus, and a chalked line, a low wall and two hoops will carry it if benches and mats cannot be set out.

Free resources for this unit

Both addresses were opened and read on 2026-08-10. Neither needs an account and neither charges. They are printed here, in the teacher section, rather than as square codes on a pupil page: both are **teacher** resource libraries, so a code inviting an eight-year-old to open one was the wrong place for them.

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Physical Education

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